

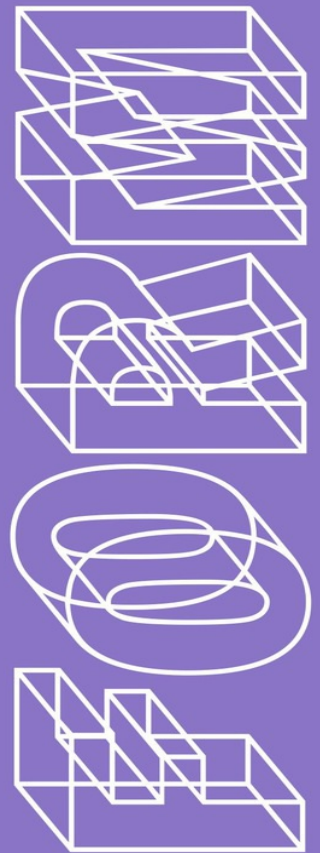
THE GRAPHIC DESIGN BOOK

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners

typography

Tracking
Leading
Kerning

Festus Atiba



The Graphic Design Book:

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners

Festus Atiba © 2020 INTRODUCTION This guide provides information for individuals who are seeking to become expert graphic designers. The guide is a work of compilation aimed at introducing the beginner to what graphic design entails and how they can use the information to build a career in graphic design for themselves. It contains a lot of useful links to resources that would help the designer on this new journey to becoming a force in the creative industry. The guide is structured in sections to allow for easy learning and understanding.

SECTIONS

Section 1 “Graphic Design” *Types of Graphic design, Specializations and what it entails to be a graphic designer.*

Section 2 “The Fundamentals and Elements of Graphic Design” *The concepts of ‘Line’, ‘Shape’, ‘Form’, ‘Texture’ and ‘Balance’*

Section 3 “Layout and Composition” *Key principles of ‘Proximity’, ‘White Space’, ‘Alignment’, ‘Contrast’, and ‘Repetition’.*

Section 4 “Typography” *Typefaces and Fonts, Kerning, Leading and Tracking How you can choose typography for your designs. “Colour” Colour Theory, Colour Wheel, Colour Models and How to adequately select a perfect colour scheme for your designs.*

Section 6 “Graphic Design Software” *The pros and cons of different design software*

Section 7 Conclusion **DISCLAIMER** The content of this book is

not fully original. Some of the texts, images, photos, illustrations and diagrams found in this work were obtained from blogs, open source websites and online educational platforms. Reasonable efforts have been made to credit these sources at the end of the book. Any liability either direct or indirect arising from the use and application of this book is hereby disclaimed.

GRAPHIC DESIGN

What is Graphic Design?

According to the American Institute of Graphic Arts (AIGA), graphic design is defined as **“the art and practice of planning and projecting ideas and experiences with visual and textual content.”**

In simple terms, graphic design is the process of visual communication and problem-solving through the use of typography, photography, iconography and illustration. It communicates certain ideas or messages in a visual way. These visuals can be as simple as a road signs, business or corporate logo, to as complex as page layouts on a website or technical schematics.

Most times, visual designs around us are taken for granted. But hidden in every design from book covers to an exit sign lies a set of design ideas that subtly influence our perceptions, decisions and choices.

Most graphic design projects have commercial purposes like advertisements and promotions. Graphic design can be used by companies to promote and sell products through advertising, by websites to convey complicated information in a digestible way through infographics, or by businesses to develop an identity through branding, among other things. Among other things, it is also used purely as a means for artistic expression.

Design can aid in selling a product or idea. It is applied to products and elements of company identity such as logos, colors, packaging and text as part of branding. Branding has become increasingly more important in the range of services offered by graphic designers. Graphic designers often form part of a branding team.

Graphic design is applied in the entertainment industry in decoration, scenery and visual story telling. Other examples of design for entertainment purposes include novels, vinyl album covers, comic books, DVD covers, opening credits and closing credits in filmmaking, and programs and props on stage. This could also include artwork used for T-shirts and other items screen-printed for sale.

Information design from scientific journals to news reporting, the presentation of opinion and facts is often improved with graphics and thoughtful compositions of visual information. Newspapers, magazines, blogs, television and film documentaries may use graphic design. With the advent of the web, information designers with experience in interactive tools are increasingly used to illustrate the background to news stories. Information design can include data visualization, which involves using programs to interpret and form data into a visually compelling presentation, and can be tied in with information graphics (known as infographic).

To understand graphic design, it is important to know the fundamental elements and principles that make up a design. These elements will help you to decide what to include in your design and how create visually stimulating designs that resonates with the consumer again and again.

Types of Graphic Design

1. Visual identity graphic design: Designers that specialize in visual identity graphic design work with brands. They create brand identity assets like logos, business cards, Letterheads, typography, color palettes and image libraries that represent a brand's personality. Here, designers often develop a set of visual brand guidelines (style guides) that describe best practices and provide examples of visual branding applied across various media. These guidelines help to ensure brand consistency throughout future applications.

2. Marketing & advertising graphic design: This refers to designs created for marketing and advertising. It involves the creation of visual content to create awareness or promote more a product, service or brand. Designers can specialize in a specific type of media (vehicle wraps or magazine ads, for example) or create a broad assortment of collateral for print, digital, and beyond. Examples include: • Postcards and flyers, Magazine and newspaper

ads, Posters, banners and billboards, Infographics, Brochures (print and digital), Vehicle wraps, Signage and trade show displays, Email marketing templates, PowerPoint presentations, Menus, Social media ads, banners and graphics, Banner and retargeting ads, Images for websites and blogs.

3. User interface graphic design: A user interface (UI) is how a user interacts with a device or application. UI design is the process of designing interfaces to make them easy to use and provide a user-friendly experience. A UI includes all of the things a user interacts with—the screen, keyboard and mouse—but in the context of graphic design, UI design focuses on the user's visual experience and the design of on-screen graphic elements like buttons, menus, microinteractions, and more. It's a UI designer's job to balance aesthetic appeal with technical functionality.

4. Publication graphic design: Publications are long-form pieces that communicate with an audience through public distribution. They have traditionally been a print medium. However, there's recently been a significant rise in digital publishing with the advent of technology. Examples include Books, Newspapers, Newsletters, Directories, Annual reports, Magazines, Catalogs.

5. Packaging graphic design: Products require some form of packaging to protect and prepare them for storage, distribution, and sale. Packaging design can also communicate directly to consumers, which makes it an extremely valuable marketing tool. Every box, bottle and bag, every can, container, or canister is a chance tell the story of a brand. Packaging design involves specialization in a specific type of packaging (like labels or beverage cans) or a specific industry (like food or children's toys). It requires top-notch conceptual and problem-solving skills in addition to a strong working knowledge of print and industrial design. They must be flexible to meet the demands of clients, marketers and manufacturers and be aware of current trends.

6. Motion graphic design (Animation): Graphics that are in motion are referred to as motion graphics. This can include animation, audio, typography, imagery, video and other effects that are used in online media, television and film. It can be found across all digital platforms, which has created all sorts of new areas and opportunities. Examples of motion graphic

design: Title sequences and end credits, Advertisements, Animated logos, Trailers, Presentations, Promotional videos, Tutorial videos, Websites, Apps, Video games, Banners, GIFs. Motion graphics designers begin by developing storyboards and then bring their concepts to life with animation, video and traditional art. Depending on the industry, a strong working knowledge of marketing, coding and 3D modeling can be definite assets.

7. Environmental graphic design: Environmental graphic design is a multidisciplinary practice that merges graphic, architectural, interior, landscape and industrial design. Designers collaborate with people in any number of these fields to plan and implement their designs. Because of that, designers typically have education and experience in both graphic design and architecture. They must be familiar with industrial design concepts and able to read and sketch architectural plans. Environmental graphic design visually connects people to places to improve their overall experience by making spaces more memorable, interesting, informative or easier to navigate. Examples of environmental graphic design: Signage, Wall murals, Museum exhibitions, Office branding, Public transportation navigation, Retail store interiors, Stadium branding, Event and conference spaces.

Career

Specializations exist across different sectors and jobs and design is an exception. Graphic design is composed of many fields and specializations, ranging from print and web design to animation and motion graphics. Though it is often difficult to decide what type of graphic designer you are because of the overlapping boundaries, specialization still exists. Therefore, designers must be adaptable and lifelong learners so they can change or add specializations throughout their careers. Many designers specialize in a single type; others focus on a set of related, similar types. This is mainly due to the inconstancy of industry demand and changing technology.

Graphic design offers opportunities and options for individuals of almost any interest. About 20 years ago, graphic design was focused on print-related items like magazines, movie posters and advertisements. Now we're living in the digital age, which has given birth to several new types of graphic design.

Today, there are many career opportunities in the design industry. These

opportunities majorly stem from advancement in technology used for design. Some of the most notable modern-day design careers include:

- **Graphic designer**
- **UI/UX Designer– User Interface/User experience designer**
- **Web designer**
- **Art director**
- **Creative director**

Other Design Careers

Web Designer: Website designer creates engaging and intuitive web pages for users. This includes overall layout, color scheme and navigation.

UI/UX Designer: They focus on ensuring a website or application is easy and satisfying to use. These designers emphasize value, usability, adoptability and desirability.

Motion graphics designer/Animator : They create motion graphics design—or animation. It involves bringing visual elements to life through special effects. They are used for TV shows, video games and movies.

Job Prospects

Demand for “traditional” graphic designers who work primarily for print publishers has fallen substantially, but that doesn’t tell the whole story. Employment of graphic designers in computer systems design services is projected to grow by 24 percent through 2028, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS). Much of this demand is spurred by business’ and organizations’ increased need for digital graphics and imagery as they aim to increase their digital presence.

As you can see, once armed with the proper knowledge and training, there are several graphic design job options out there. You have the ability to cater your career to your personal skills and interests. Section 2

FUNDAMENTALS OF DESIGN

The fundamentals of design are the foundation of every visual medium, from fine art to modern web design. They're even present in seemingly unimportant details, like the fonts that make up most compositions. They help

the designer to achieve effective composition, balance and aesthetically stable designs.

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GREEN WHEAT FIELDS, AUVERS

Vincent van Gogh
Dutch, 1853 - 1890

1890
Oil on canvas
28.5 x 36 inches

NATIONAL GALLERY OF ART
Collection of Mr. and Mrs. Paul Mellon

Basic Elements and Principles

The basic elements include: **line, shape, form, texture, and balance**. Others include: **Color, Size, and Space**. They might not seem like much on their own, but together, they're part of almost everything we see and create. Principles include: Balance, Contrast, Emphasis, Movement, Proportion, Rhythm

However, the designer is not limited in any way to any of these principles. Because **creativity has no boundaries**.

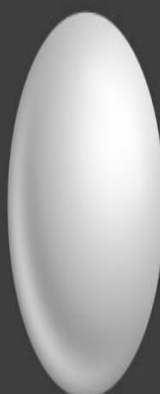
Line



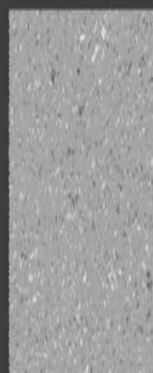
Shape



Form



Texture



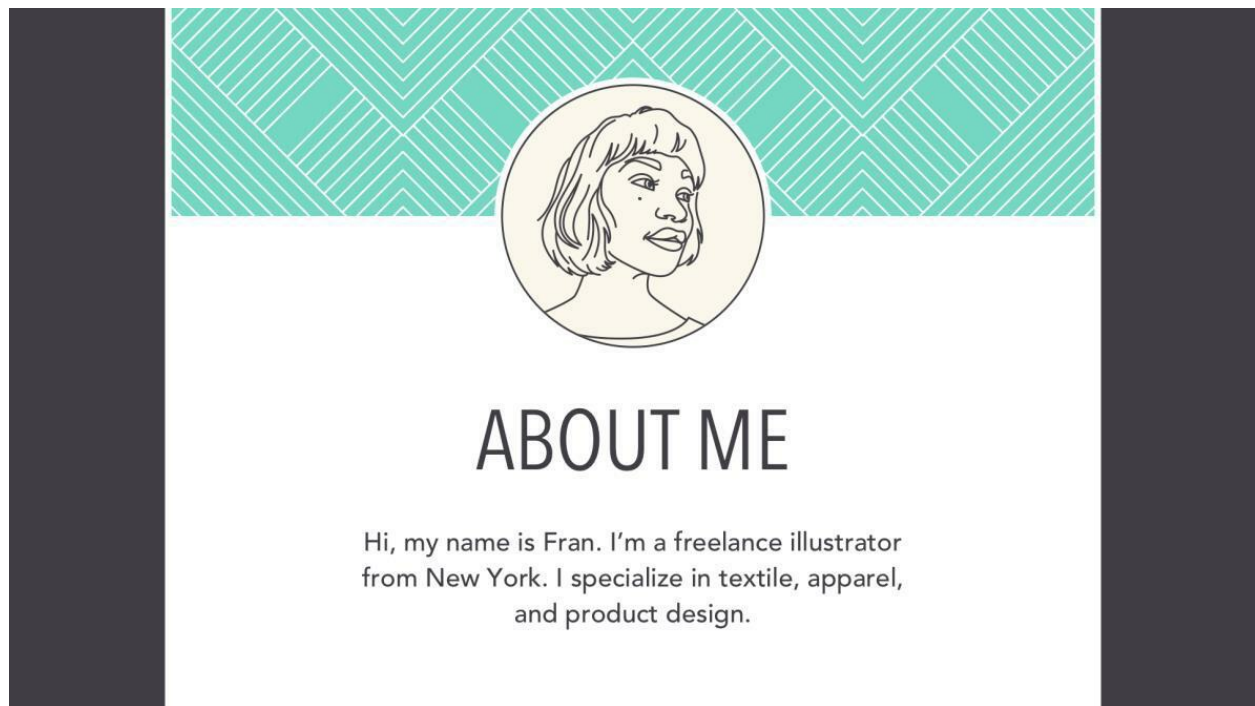
Balance

The fundamentals can be intimidating at first, especially if you don't consider yourself an artist. But keep an open mind—there's a lot they can teach you about working with different assets and creating simple visuals from scratch.

Line

A line is a shape that connects two or more points. It can be fat, thin, wavy, or jagged —the list goes on. Every possibility gives the line a slightly different feel.

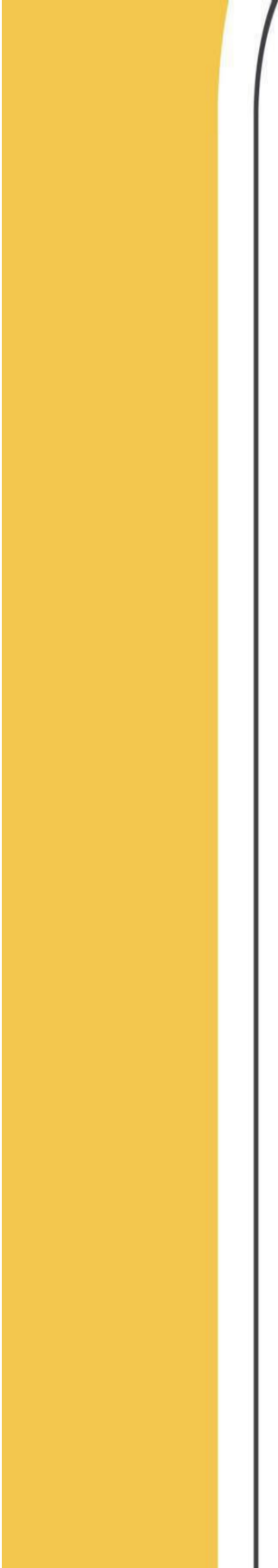
Lines appear frequently in design; for example, in drawings and illustrations. They're also common in graphic elements, like textures, patterns, and backgrounds.



Lines can be used in simple compositions, too —for organization, emphasis, or just decoration. In the example below, lines have been used to create a flow chart that guides the reader's eye from one element to the next. When working with lines, pay attention to things like weight, colour, texture, and style. These subtle qualities can have a big impact on the way your design is perceived.



Look for places where lines are hiding in plain sight; for example, in text. Even here, experimenting with different line qualities can give you very different results.



NO PAI



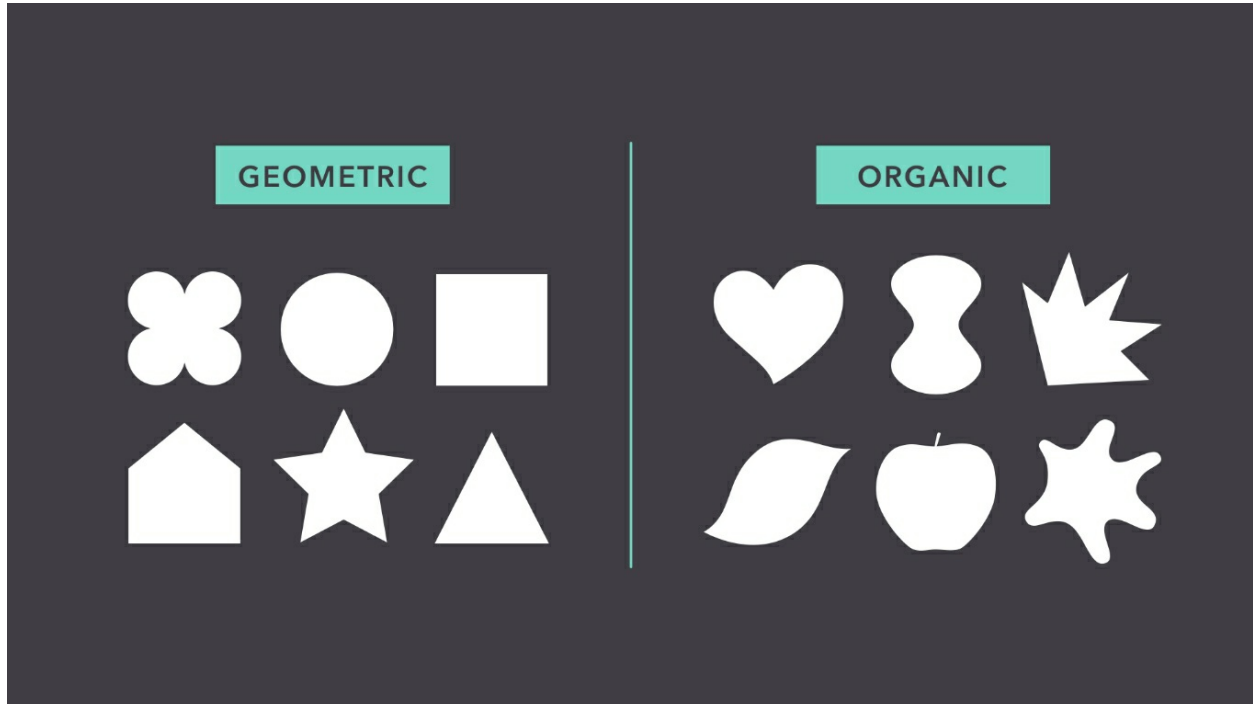
The image features the text "NO PAI" in a bold, dark blue, sans-serif font. The letters "N" and "O" are accompanied by dashed lines and arrows indicating their stroke order: the "N" is formed by three strokes (vertical down, diagonal down-right, vertical up), and the "O" is formed by two strokes (a counter-clockwise circle and a vertical line). To the left of the text is a thick yellow vertical bar and a thin black line that curves at the top. Below the text is a thick red horizontal bar.

Shape

A shape is any two-dimensional area with a recognizable boundary. This includes circles, squares, triangles, and so on.



Shapes fall into two distinct categories: geometric (or regular) and organic (where the shapes are more free form).



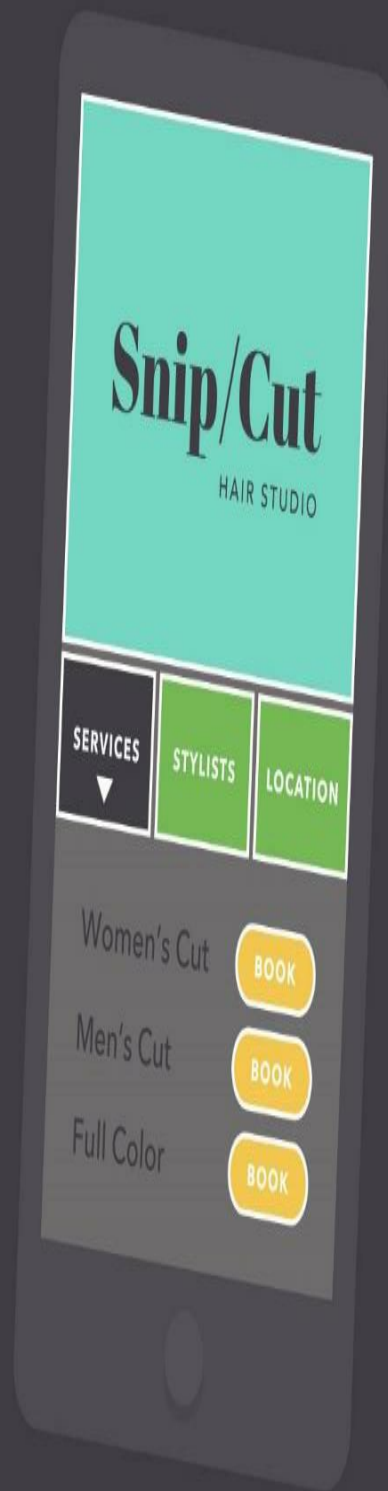
Shapes are a vital part of communicating ideas visually. They give images heft and make them recognizable. We understand street signs, symbols, and even abstract art largely because of shapes.



Shapes have a surprising number of uses in everyday design. They can help you organize or separate content, create simple illustrations, or just add interest to your work. See if you can spot the many examples in the image below.



Shapes are important because they're the foundation of so many things. Learn to look for them in other designs, and soon you'll start seeing them everywhere.

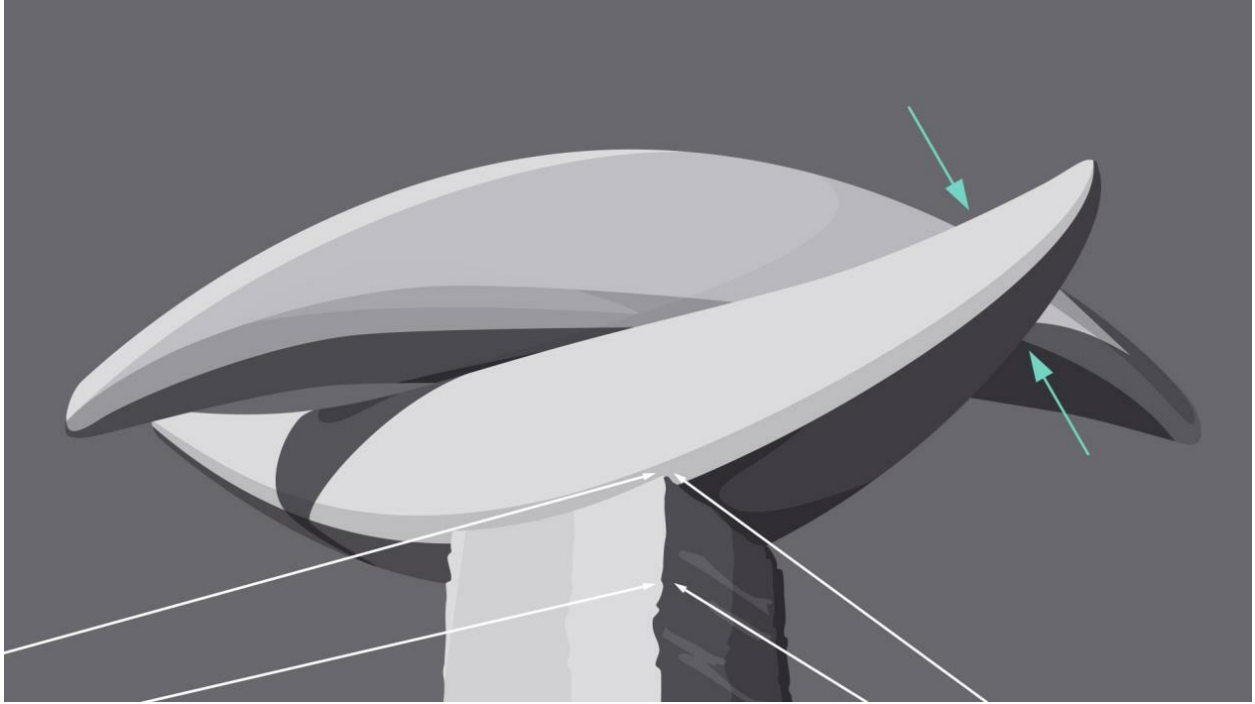


Form

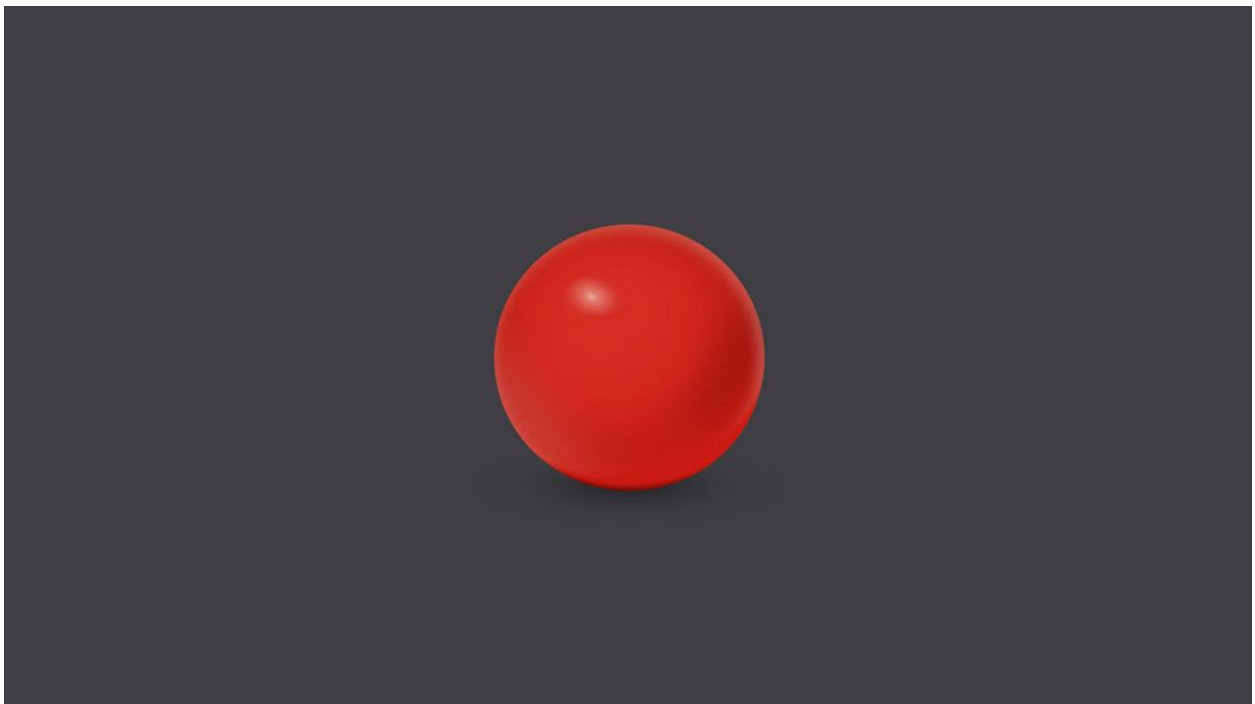
When a shape becomes 3D, we call it a form. Forms make up a variety of things in the real world, including sculptures, architecture, and other three-dimensional objects.



However, forms don't have to be three-dimensional shapes. They can also be implied through illustration, using techniques like light, shadow, and perspective to create the illusion of depth.



In two-dimensional design, form makes realism possible. Without it, renderings like the image below—a ball with highlights and shading—simply wouldn't be the same.



Even images that are less realistic use similar techniques to create dimension.

Below, the lighting and shading are stylized, but still hint at form and depth.



In everyday composition, the purpose of form is the same, but on a smaller scale. For example, a simple shadow can create the illusion of layers or give an object a sense of place.

Basic forms can bring a touch of realism to your work, which is a powerful tool when used in moderation.

Texture

Texture is the physical quality of a surface. Like form, it can be part of a three-dimensional object, as in the example below (a small prickly cactus in a shiny ceramic pot).



Or it can be implied through illustration, suggesting that it would have texture if it existed in real life. In design, texture adds depth and tactility to otherwise flat images. Objects can appear smooth, rough, hard, or soft, depending on the elements at play.



For beginners, textures make great background images and can add a lot of interest to your work. Look closely, and you may find texture in unexpected places, like distressed fonts and smooth, glossy icons. Just be careful not to go overboard—too much texture in a single design can quickly become overwhelming.



Balance

Balance is the equal distribution of visual weight (more specifically, how much any one element attracts the viewer's eye). Balance can be affected by many things, including colour, size, number, and negative space.



Mastering balance can be tricky for beginners because it does take some intuition. Luckily, the design world is full of examples that can help you understand its different iterations.



Symmetrical designs are the same or similar on both sides of an axis. They feel balanced because each side is effectively the same (if not identical).



Asymmetrical designs are different, but the weight is still evenly distributed. The composition is balanced because it calls attention to the right things (in

this example, the person's name and company logo).



João Montes

OWNER/DESIGNER

1605 SELWYN DRIVE

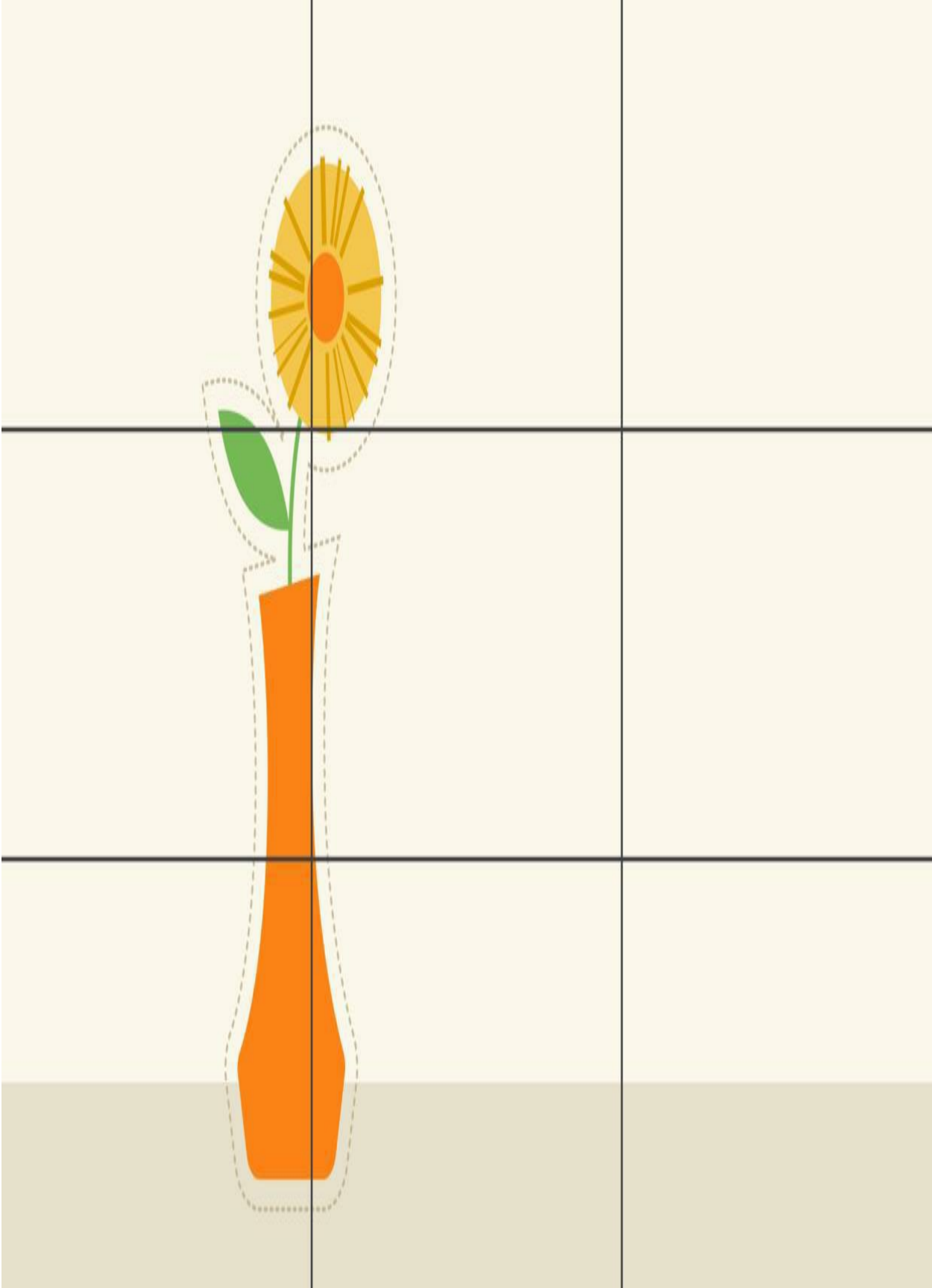
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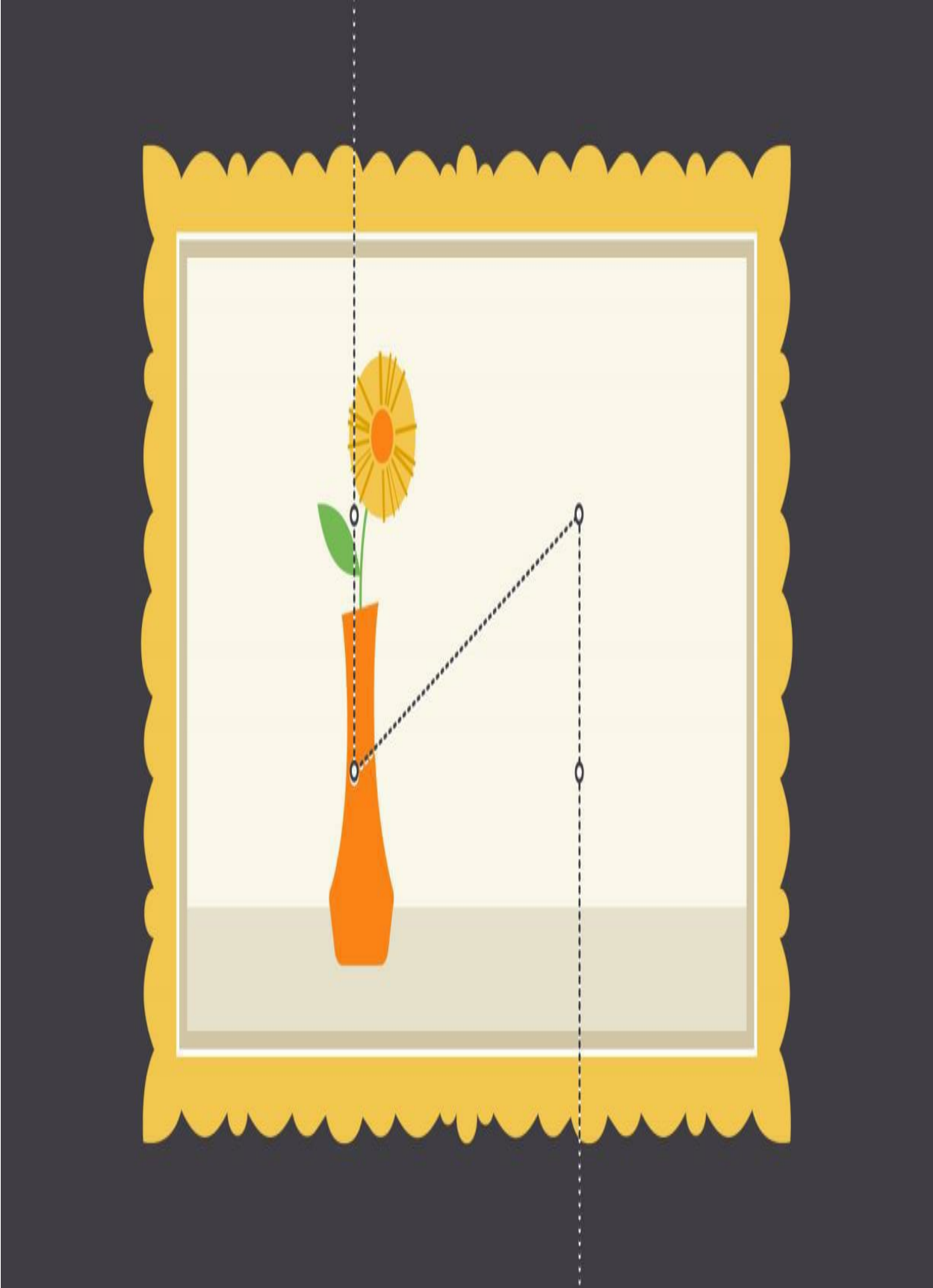


The Rule of Thirds

Many people, including designers and photographers, use a strategy called the rule of thirds. This imagines your work area divided into a 3x3 grid. The focal point of the image is placed on or near one of the grid lines, creating visual balance with the rest of the space.



We find this type of composition appealing because, according to studies, the human eye naturally follows this path when scanning a design.



Putting it all together

The fundamentals of design are all about the bigger picture—in other words, learning to appreciate the many small details that make up every composition.

Shape

Form

Balance

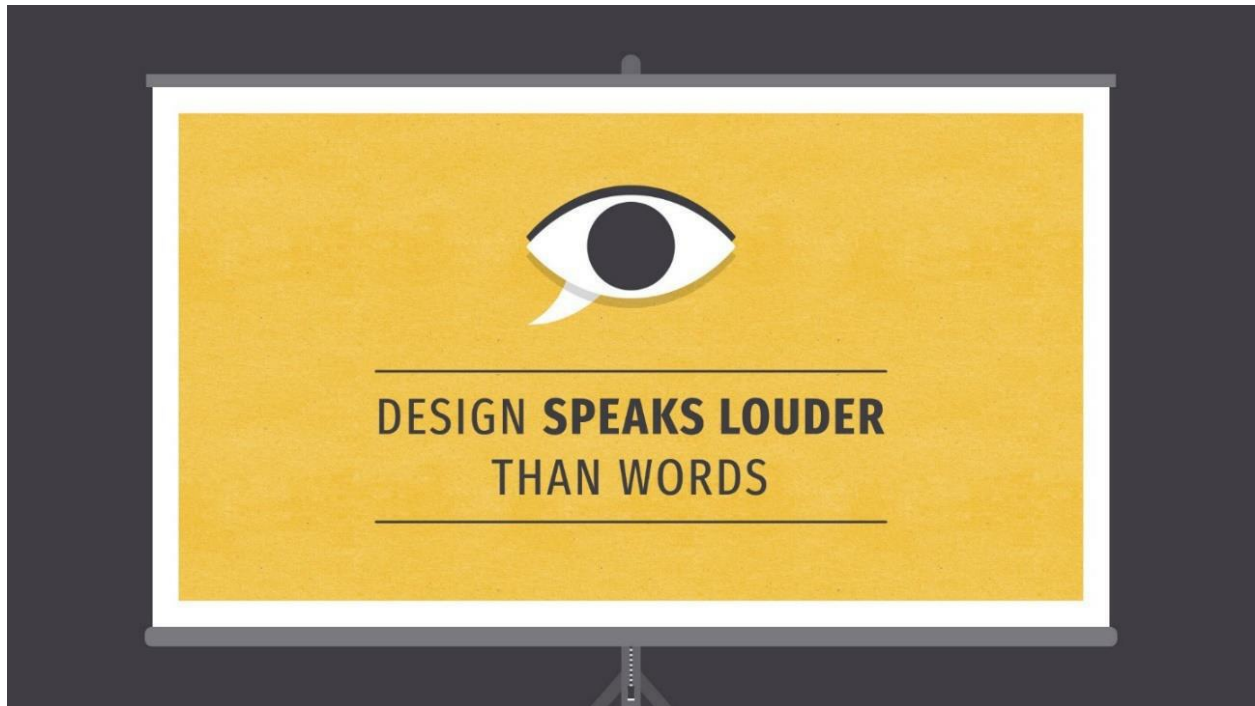
Texture

Line

THE BIGGER PICTURE

Visual Marketing for Entrepreneurs

This insight can be applied to almost any type of project, whether you're creating your own graphics or just looking for simple ways to enhance your work.



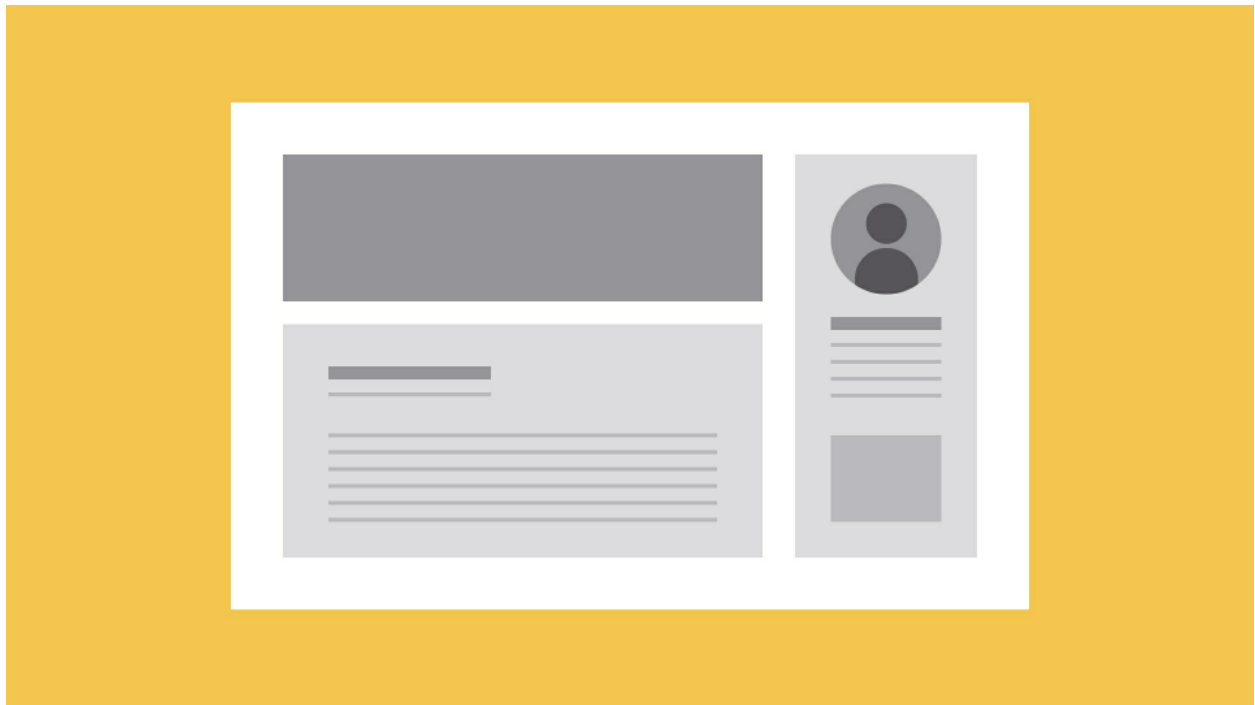
Understanding these basic fundamentals is very important to creating stunning designs that would be remembered for a long time. It is very important that every rule is followed for maximal effect in your design work.
Section 3

LAYOUT AND COMPOSITION

In any design, a balance has to be achieved between the visual impact and communication aspects. To achieve this, it is best to consider layout and composition well.

What is composition?

In many ways, layout and composition are the building blocks of design. They give your work structure and make it easier to navigate, from the margins on the sides to the content in between.



Why is composition so important? In short, it 's the way your content is arranged. It doesn't matter if you're working with text, images, or elements in a graphic; without a thoughtful, well-composed layout, your work would basically fall apart.

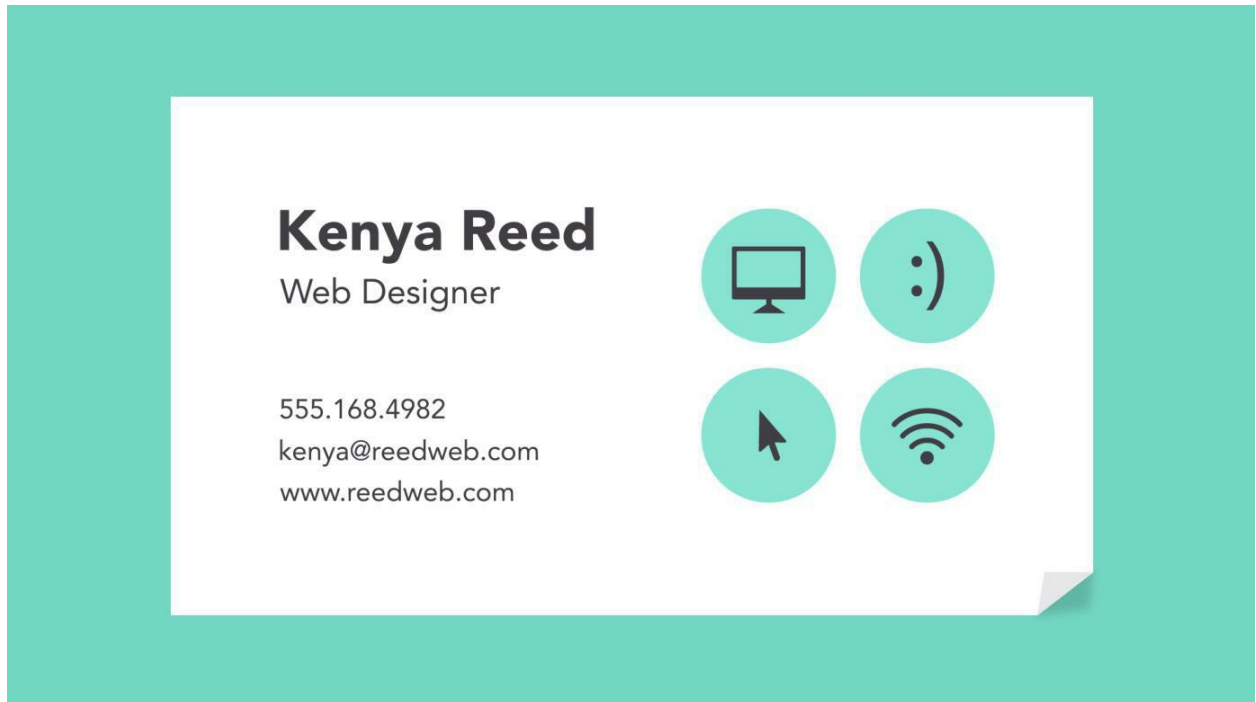
Five basic principles

The key to mastering layout and composition is to think like a designer. Luckily, it 's easier than it sounds. There are five basic principles that can help you transform your work and sharpen your eye for design. Keep them in mind during your next project, and look for ways to apply them.

- 1 Proximity
- 2 White space
- 3 Alignment
- 4 Contrast
- 5 Repetition

Proximity

Proximity is all about using visual space to show relationships in your content. In practice, it's pretty simple—all you have to do is make sure related items are grouped together (for instance, blocks of text or elements in a graphic, as in the example below).



Groups that are NOT related to each other should be separated to visually emphasize their lack of a relationship. All in all, this makes your work easier to understand at a glance, whether it's purely text or something more visual.

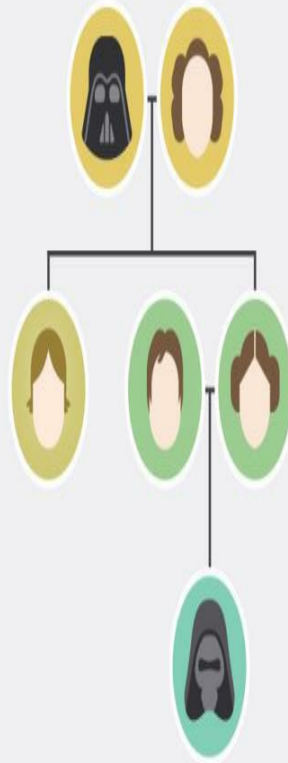
Old-Fashioned Shortcake

INGREDIENTS

2 cups flour
1/2 teaspoon salt
2 tablespoons sugar
4 teaspoons baking powder
3 tablespoons shortening
3/4 cup milk
1 quart berries

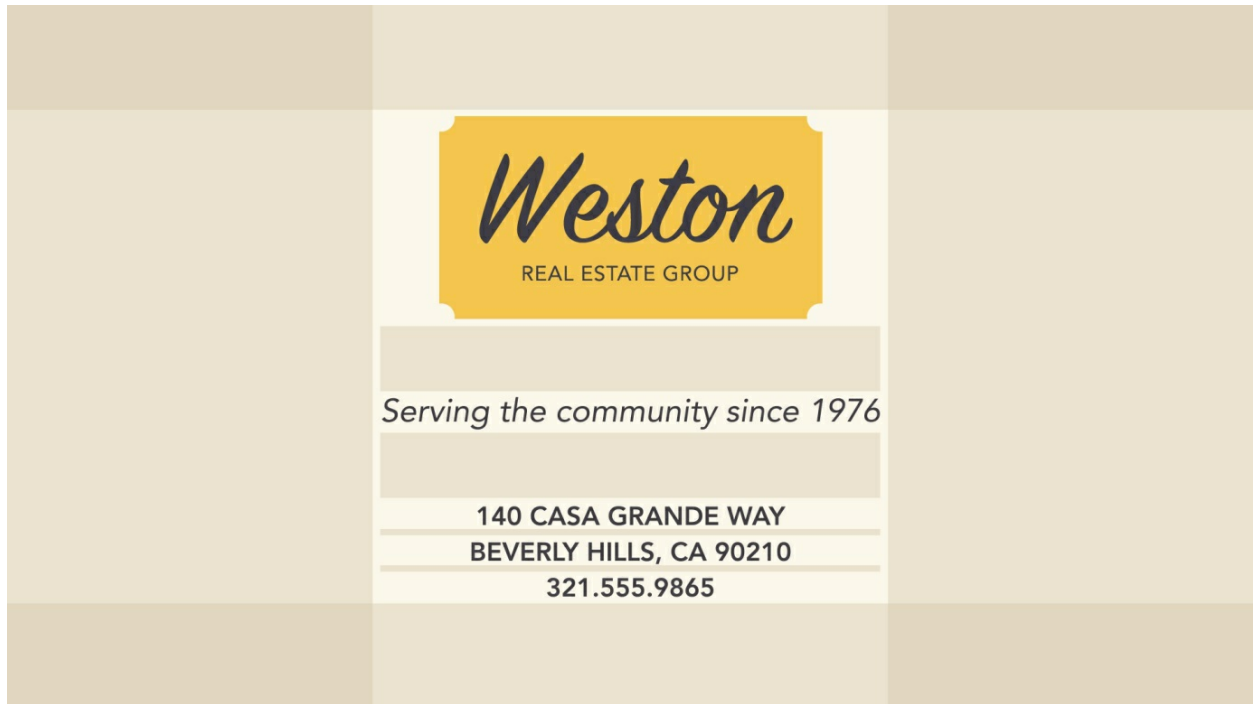
Sift dry ingredients; mix in shortening. Add milk to make a soft dough, then smooth out lightly. Bake in greased layer cake tin for 20 to 25 minutes. Split, butter, and spread sweetened crushed berries or other fruit between layers.

Family Tree



White Space

White space is an important part of every composition. Now, this doesn't mean literal white space; it just means negative space, like the spaces between your content, between lines, and even the outer margins.



There's no one way to use white space correctly, but it's good to understand its purpose. White space helps you define and separate different sections; it gives your content room to breathe. If your work ever starts to feel cluttered or uncomfortable, a little white space might be just what the doctor ordered.

**“Keep your face
to the sunshine
and you cannot
see a shadow.”**

— HELEN KELLER



Alignment

Alignment is something you deal with all the time, even if you don't realize it. Whenever you type an email or create a document, the text is aligned automatically.

Alignment



Whenever you type an email
or create a document,
the text is aligned automatically.

When aligning objects by yourself (for instance, images or separate text boxes), getting it right can be tricky. The most important thing is to be consistent.

It might help to imagine your content arranged inside of a grid, just like the example below. Notice how there's an invisible line centering each image to the text? Each grouping is also evenly spaced and aligned, with equal-sized margins.



SEE

no evil



HEAR

no evil



SPEAK

no evil

It's this attention to detail that makes the composition easier to navigate. Without consistent alignment, your work could start to feel disorganized.

Contrast

Contrast simply means difference – that one item is different from another. Light and dark, big and small, bold and subtle. In layout and composition, contrast can help you do many things, like catch the reader's eye, create emphasis, or call attention to something important.

To create contrast in the example below, we've used colour, more than one style of text, and objects of differing sizes. This makes the design more dynamic and, therefore, more effective at communicating its message.

CAUTION

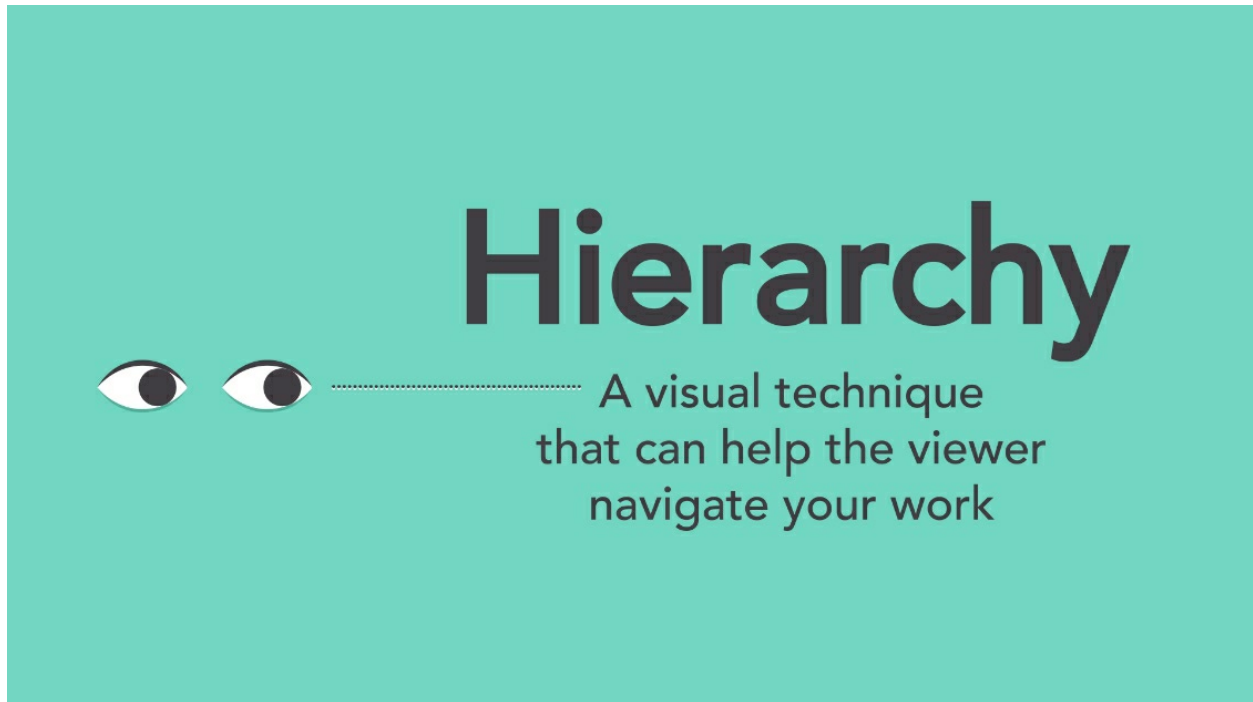
RADIATION

**MAY CAUSE
SUPERPOWERS**



Hierarchy

Contrast is also closely tied to hierarchy, which is a visual technique that can help the viewer know the importance of each element in your design in relation to the rest. It help to navigate your work. In other words, it shows them where to begin and where to go next using different levels of emphasis.



Establishing hierarchy is simple: Just decide which elements you want the reader to notice first, then make them stand out. High-level or important items are usually larger, bolder, or more eye-catching in some way.

Remember, when everything stands out, nothing stands out.

Save the Date

For the marriage of

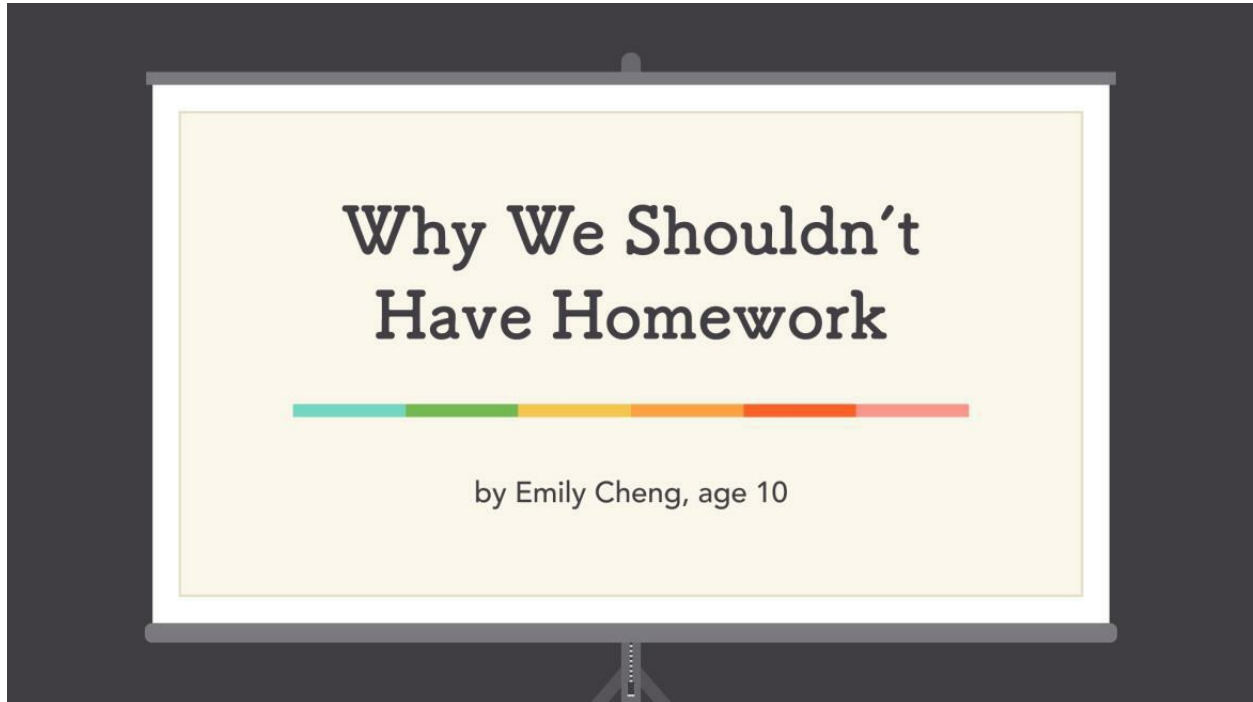
COREY & ANTHONY

Las Vegas, Nevada

January 1, 2018

Repetition

Repetition is a reminder that every project should have a consistent look and feel. This means finding ways to reinforce your design by repeating or echoing certain elements.



For instance, if you have a specific colour palette, look for ways to carry it through. If you've chosen a special header style, use it every time.

Disadvantages of Homework

- I don't like it
- Takes too long
- Boring
- Unfair
- Reasons



It's not just for aesthetic reasons—being consistent can also make your work easier to read. When viewers know what to expect, they can relax and focus on the content.

Benefits of No Homework



Putting it all together

You might say layout and composition are the unsung heroes of design. It's easy to overlook their role, but they're part of everything you do.



The principles you just learned can help you elevate any project. All it takes is a little attention to detail and you can create beautiful, professional-looking compositions.



Section 4

TYPOGRAPHY

Today, typography used in designs convey different messages to the viewer: classical ones are for a strong personality, while more modern ones may convey clean, neutral look. Bold typefaces are used for making statements and attracting attention.

Typography is the art of arranging letters and text in a way that makes the copy legible, clear, and visually appealing to the viewer. Typography involves font style, appearance, and structure, which aims to elicit certain emotions and convey specific messages. In short, typography is what brings the text to life.

Why is Typography Important?

Typography is so much more than just choosing beautiful fonts: it is an important component of graphic design. Good typography will establish a strong visual hierarchy, provide a graphic balance to your design.

1. Typography builds brand recognition

Audiences associate a particular typeface featured on a design with a

particular type of brand. For example, typography in advertising often reflects a company's brand. This is especially true for logos of brands which are made with certain typefaces. E.g. Coca-Cola. Using unique, consistent typography can help to carry a brand forward because their designs (advertisement materials: flyers, banners etc.) are visually appealing to their audience.

2. Typography holds the attention of the readers

Good typography could be the difference between someone accepting a design. Good typography can be visually stimulating and memorable, and thus typography plays a huge role in the process of design.

3. Typography influences decision making

Typography has a profound effect on the way that users digest and perceive the information conveyed by the text. Eye-catching type is much more persuasive than weak fonts that don't reinforce the message of the text. This is true especially for brand designs that aim at attracting the attention of a potential buyer or customer.

The Different Elements of Typography

1. Typefaces and Fonts

There's some confusion surrounding the difference between typefaces and fonts, with many treating the two as synonymous. A typeface is a design style which comprises a myriad of characters of varying sizes and weight, whereas a font is a graphical representation of text character. Put simply, a typeface is a family of related fonts, while fonts refer to the weights, widths, and styles that constitute a typeface.

Choice of typeface or font is often used to draw attention to a particular design, when combined with efficient use of colour, shapes, and images.

The Difference between a Typeface and a Font

There are three basic kinds of typeface: **Serif, Sans-Serif, And Decorative/Display.**

- **Serif** comes from the Greek word meaning. A serif font has little feet attached to each letter – a classic style of font used in books- the little feet guide u-your eyes along lines of text.
- **Sans** is French word meaning without. So, san serif means without serif –

This type of fonts is modern and it is styled to look clean on digital screens.

Decorative/Display typeface includes fonts that are neither serif nor sans-serif. These types of fonts are usually used for headlines and because of their differences, they are best used in small doses. Other types of fonts include: Monospaced, Script and Symbol.

Few Tips to help you get the perfect Font Pairing

To keep a design neat and organized, a good designer will never use more than three fonts—and keep decorative fonts to a minimum. Alternatively, pick fonts that are contrasting and complementary. Most graphic designers will pair serif fonts with sans-serif fonts, such as putting main body text in a serif font and putting your title in a sans-serif font, or vice-versa. You could also pick something that is round and sort of match it with something tall. Fonts that are opposite should attract each other to create harmony in your design. Usually, decorative fonts are used for digital designs aimed at attracting the attention of viewers- and they are used in such a way that it is visually stimulating. The easiest way to pair fonts is to use one font family. You can pick a font with different weights, like light, medium and bold, and you can create contrast with these fonts easily.

1. Contrast

Contrast is used to vary the shades of a Most designers create contrast by playing around with varying typefaces, colours, styles, and sizes to create designs that are unique and stylish enough to generate impact. Different types are used in fonts for emphasis

1. Consistency

Keeping your typefaces consistent is key to avoiding a confusing and messy design. When conveying information, it's essential to stick to the same font style, so your viewers can understand what they're reading, and begin to notice a pattern in your design.

4. White space

Often referred to as 'negative space,' white space is the space around text or graphics. It's often overlooked and tends to go unnoticed by the user, but proper use of white space ensures the design is organized and neat. White space can even draw attention to the text and provides an overall aesthetically pleasing experience. White space often takes the form of margins, padding,

or just areas with no text or graphics.

5. Alignment

Alignment is the process of unifying and composing text, graphics, and images to ensure there is equal space, size, and distances between each element. Many UI designers create margins to ensure that their logo, header, and body of the text are aligned with each other. When aligning your user interface, it's good practice to pay attention to industry standards. For example, aligning your text to the right will seem counterintuitive for readers who read left to right.

6. Colour

Colour is one of the most exciting elements of typography. This is where designers can really get creative with their text. Text colour or font colour can make the text stand. Colour is used for its emotional effect in conveying the tone and nature of the message.

1. Hierarchy

Establishing hierarchy is one of the most vital principles of typography. Typographical hierarchy aims to create a clear distinction between textual information should be noticed and read first. In an age of short attention spans brought about by social media, designers are urged to be concise and create typefaces that allow users to consume the necessary information in short amounts of time.

Hierarchy can be created using sizing, colour, weight, contrast, and alignment. For example, if you have a text or character in red and larger than the others, it is a visual clue to the viewers that it's an important piece of the design. The most typical example of typographical hierarchy is size. Important information is usually larger and in standard text.

1. Size

All typefaces and fonts are not created equal. Some are fat and wide; some are thin and narrow. So, words set in different typefaces can take up a very different amount of space on the page.

The height of each character is known as its 'x-height' (quite simply because it's based on the 'x' character). When pairing different typefaces, it's

generally wise to use those that share a similar xheight.

The width of each character is known as the 'set width'. This spans the body of the letter, plus the space that acts as a buffer between one letterform and the next.

The most common method used to measure type is the point system, which dates back to the 18th century. One point is 1/72 inch. 12 points make one pica, a unit used to measure column widths.

Type sizes can also be measured in inches, millimetres, or pixels.

Leading

Leading describes the vertical space between each line in a paragraph. It's so named because, in the days of metal typesetting, strips of lead were used to separate lines of type. For legible body text that's comfortable to read, a general rule is that your leading value should be anything between 1.25 and 1.5 times greater than the font size.

Tracking

Tracking is the process of adjusting the spacing of all characters in a word, and is applied evenly. It is simply described as the horizontal space between characters or words.

Kerning

Kerning is similar to tracking, but they are not the same thing. Kerning is the spacing between individual letters. Kerning is the process of adjusting the space between characters to create a harmonious pairing. For example, where an uppercase 'A' meets an uppercase 'V', their diagonal strokes are usually kerned so that the top left of the 'V' sits above the bottom right of the 'A'. Like this together, VA.



How do you choose the right typeface or font for your design?

With so many different fonts and typefaces to choose from, it's easy to feel overwhelmed. The process of choosing typefaces or fonts depends on a few other things apart from creativity on the path of the designer. Thus, making the right choice depends on so much more than just seeing what looks nice. Here are a few key considerations based on the following principles:

1. Legibility and Readability

Legibility “refers to perception” (being able to see as determined by physical limitations of the eye) and readability “refers to comprehension” (understanding the meaning). Good graphic designers aim to achieve excellence in both.

Readability and Legibility are often used synonymously, typographically they are separate but related concepts. Legibility describes how easily individual characters can be distinguished from one another. Readability refers to how easy it is to read the text as a whole, as opposed to the individual character

recognition described by legibility.

The typeface chosen should be legible. That is, it should be read without effort. Sometimes legibility is simply a matter of type size; more often, however, it is a matter of typeface design. Case selection always influences legibility. In general, typefaces that are true to the basic letterforms are more legible than typefaces that have been condensed, expanded, embellished, or abstracted.

Don't skimp on readability and legibility. Both of them are vital to the overall outlook of a design: There's nothing worse than a design that looks good but is entirely illegible or readable. When deciding what typefaces or fonts to include in your design, set the style, aesthetic, and voice aside and reflect on whether the font is legible and readable. Can the text be legible without strain? Are the characters distinct enough?

2. Personality

One of the first things to consider is the type of design you are creating. Most importantly, it is imperative that the typography reflects the personality of the brand or product. A good starting point when faced with this challenge is to define the core traits of your brand, and start to gather typefaces that reflect these traits. From there, you can begin to notice a trend.

3. Tone

Are you creating it for a corporate organization? Does it reflect a certain age group – children, teenagers or adults? It is important to consider how the typeface or font harmonizes with the tone of the message. For example, if you want to convey serious or important information, choose a less stylized or decorative font that is both clearly legible and will limit distraction.

4. Be Creative

If you're not sure where to start, try out your different typefaces and fonts on your own design and see what it looks like. This may be difficult at first but it would yield some positive results when applied with the other principles above. Also taking some time to see what other people are doing can prove useful. Open your eyes to the typography that you see around you. Can you notice similar patterns? Can you see good and bad examples of typography? Looking up how typography is used in designs online will give you some good ideas of what type of typefaces or fonts can be used and combined

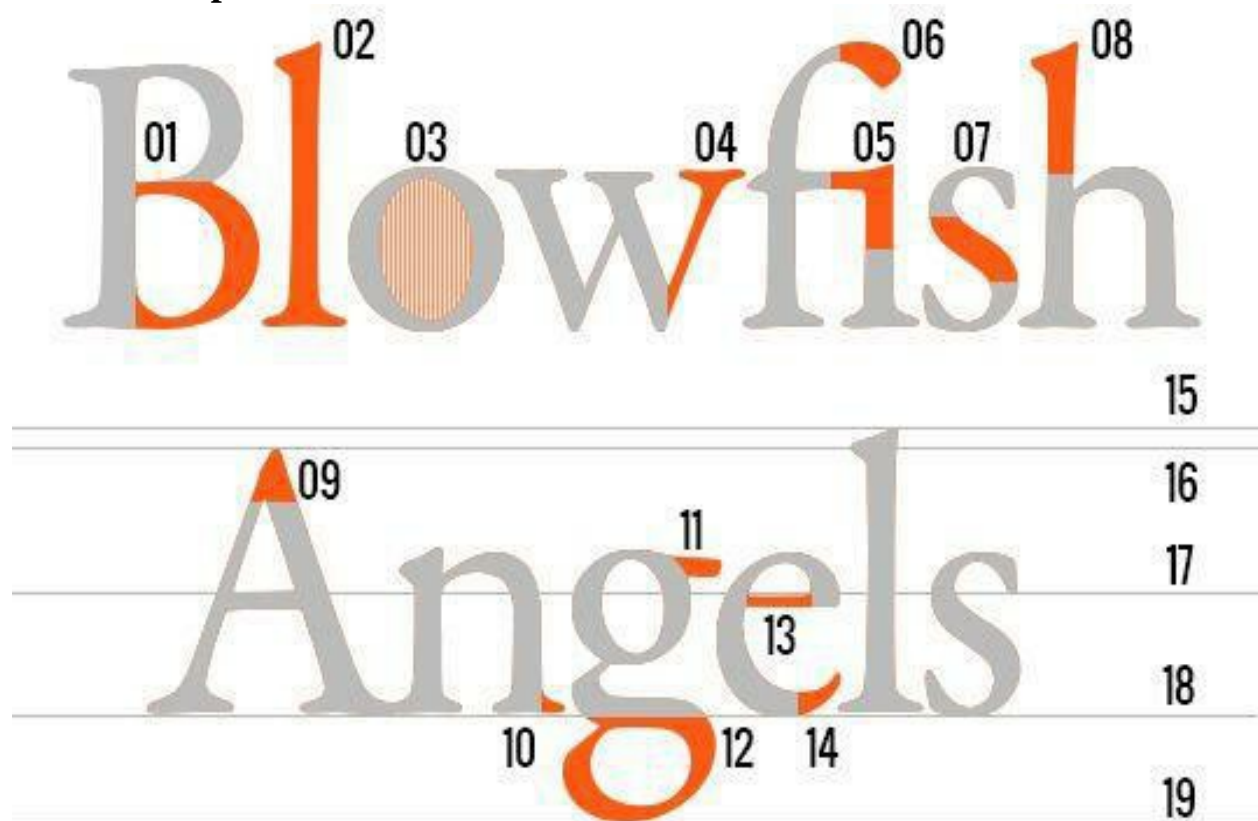
together in designs.

Conclusion

Mastering typography is an important step in becoming a good graphic designer. Designers often use typefaces to set a theme and mood in a design. For example, in advertisement designs (using bold, large text to convey a particular message to the reader is really important).

If you're not sure where to start, why not head to your favourite online channels such as Instagram to see different kinds of designs and making a note of what, where, when and how typefaces and fonts are commonly used for various types of designs.

Font Description



1. Bowl; 2. Stem; 3. Counter; 4. Arm; 5. Ligature; 6. Terminal; 7. Spine; 8. Ascender; 9. Apex; 10. Serif; 11. Ear; 12. Descender; 13. Crossbar; 14. Finial; 15. Ascender height; 16. Cap height; 17. X-height; 18. Baseline; 19. Descender line

Section 5

COLOUR

The Power of Colour

Color is a deeply rooted form of communication —a universal language than can be understood 60,000 times faster than text alone. Colour plays a vital role in design and everyday life. It can draw your eye to an image.

Sometimes it can trigger an emotional response. It can even communicate something important without using words at all.



However, choosing colour for any design (logo, flyer, pamphlet, brochure, magazine or book cover etc.) can be a challenging task. In creating designs that great, there is a whole science to colour and how it is used. This science is what enables us to know which colours to match together to create designs that look good.

So, what is the science that enables us to know which colours look good together and which ones don't? The answer is simple: **Colour theory**.

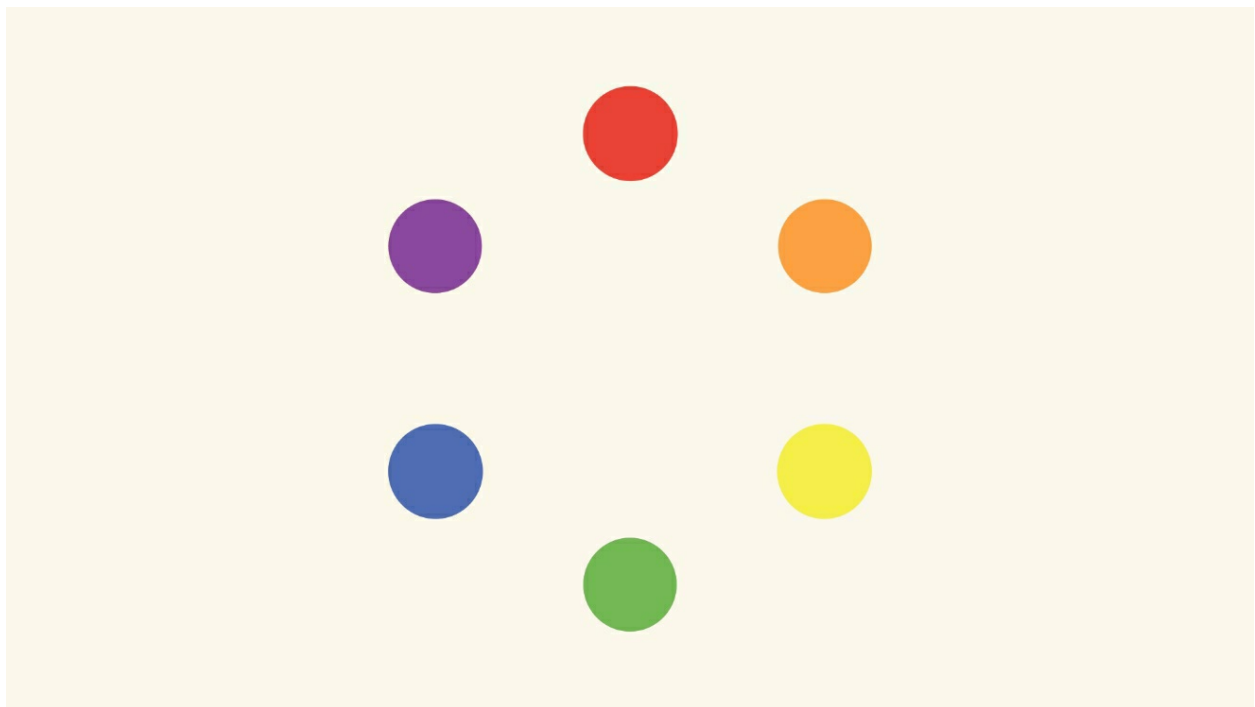
Colour Theory both the science and art of using colour. It explains how humans perceive colour; and the visual effects of how colours mix, match or

contrast with each other. Colour theory also involves the messages colours communicate; and the methods used to replicate colour.

Artists and designers have followed colour theory for centuries, but anyone can learn more about it. It can help you feel confident in many different situations, whether it's choosing colours for a design or putting together the perfect outfit. With a little insight, you'll be looking at colour in a whole new way. Remember that colour combinations for graphic design are not absolute, they can be combined in different ways. So do not be afraid to experiment.

Colour Basics

Let's start at the beginning with a refresher on the basics. Remember learning about primary and secondary colours in school? Then you already have some knowledge of colour theory. Secondary colours are created by combining two primary colours. Red and yellow make orange; yellow and blue make green; and blue and red make purple.



If we mix these colours together, we get even more in-between shades, like red-orange and yellowgreen. All together, they form what's called a **colour wheel**.

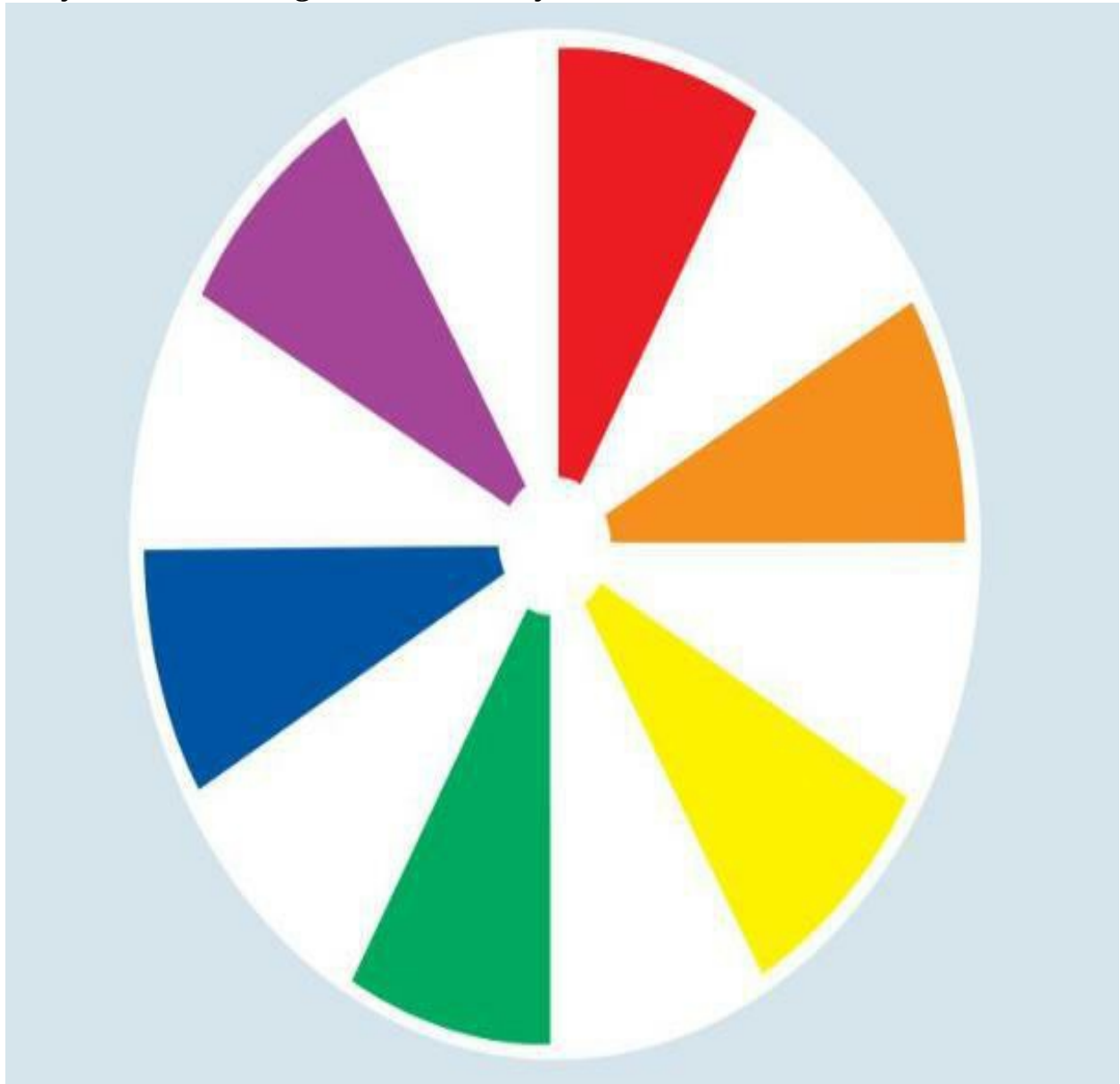
In colour theory, colours are organized on a colour wheel and grouped into 3 categories: primary colours, secondary colours and tertiary colours.

Colour Wheel

The colour wheel for graphic design is a circle with different coloured sections used to show the relationship between colours.

Primary Colours

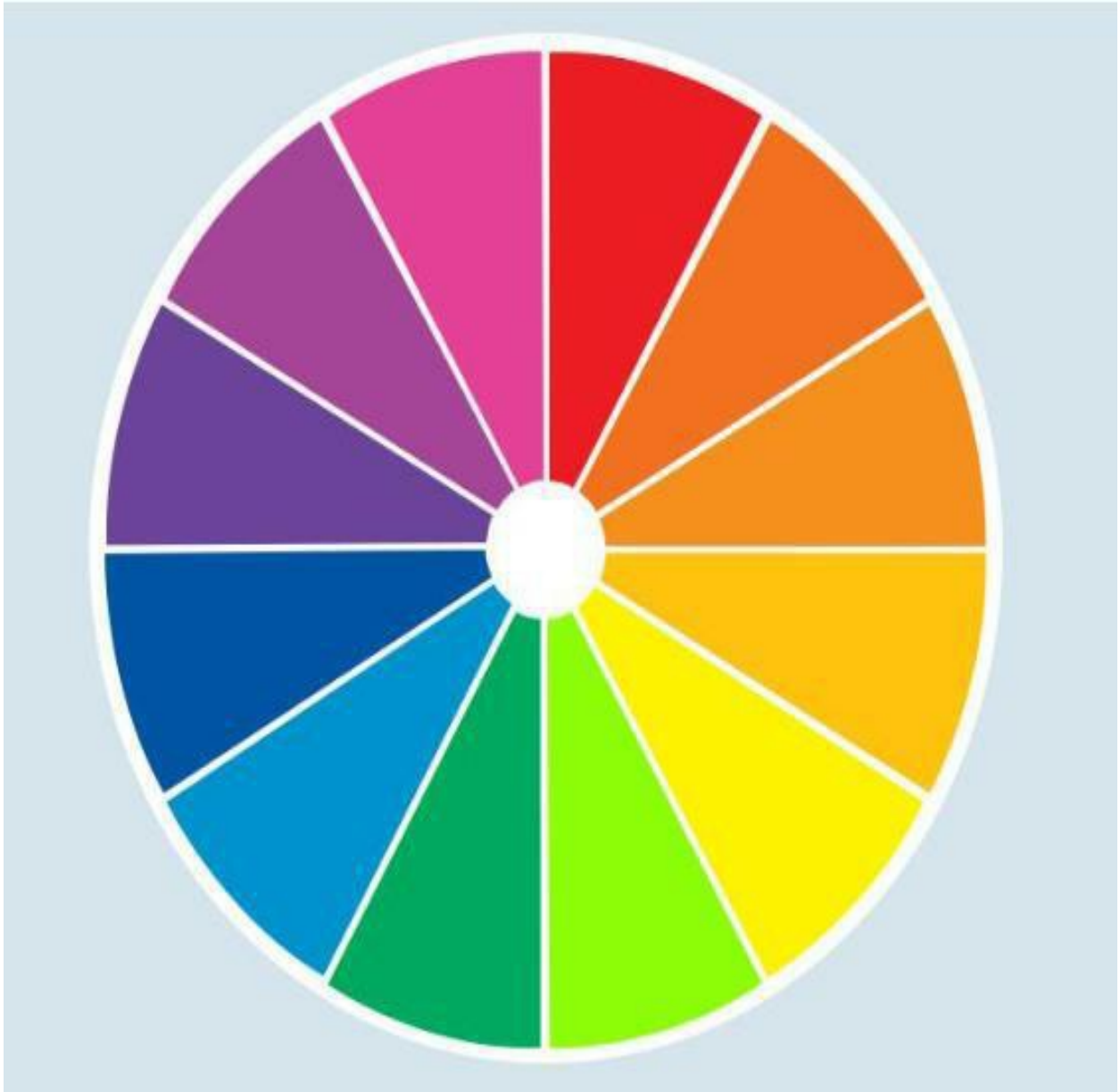
The typical colour wheel includes the blue, red, and yellow primary colours. They are the building blocks for every other colours.



Secondary Colour

Secondary colours are colours that come from mixing two primary colours.

There are three secondary colours.



Here is the combination to create secondary colours:

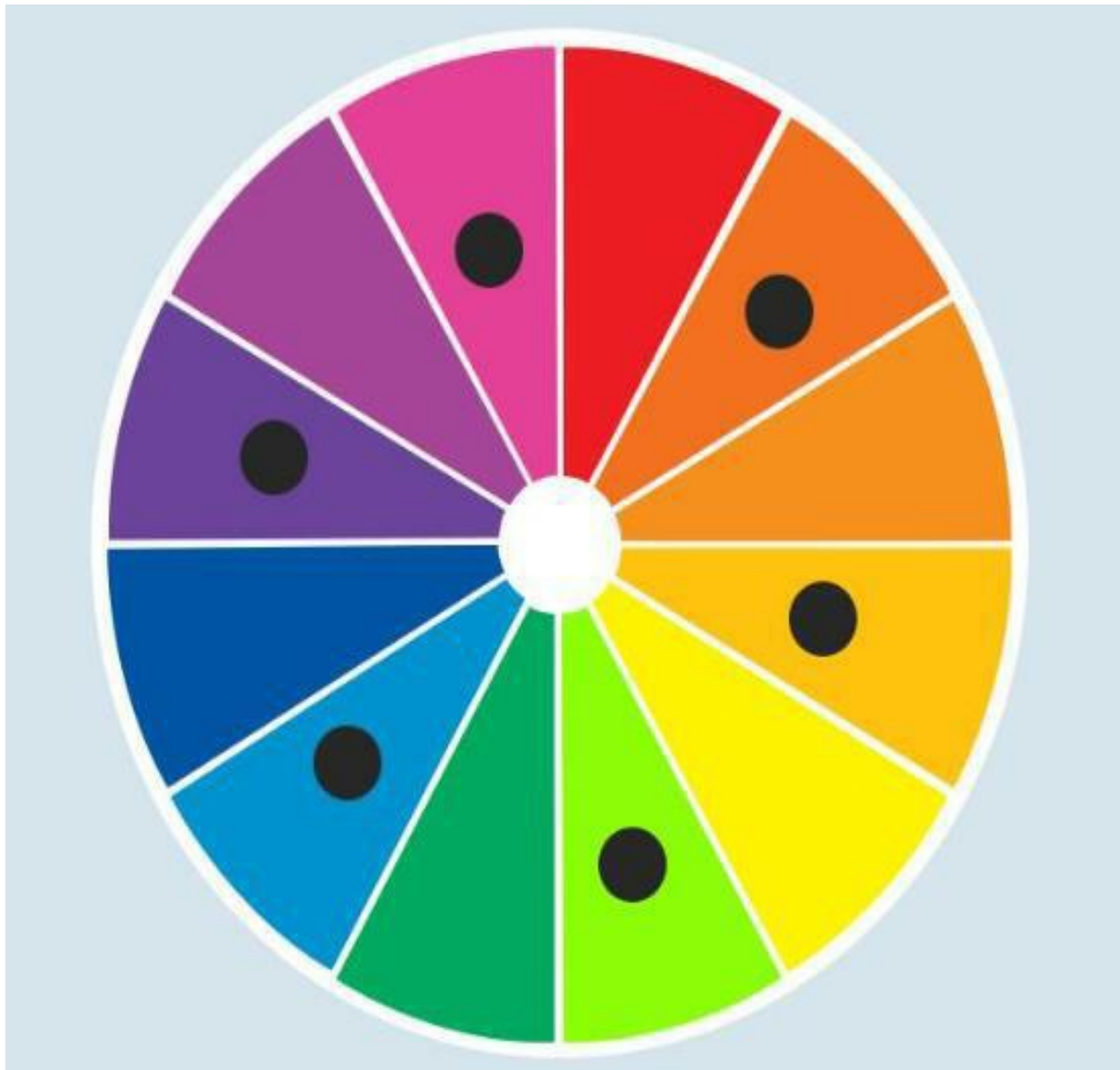
Purple = Red + Blue,

Orange = Red + Yellow

Green = Yellow + blue.

Tertiary colours

Tertiary colours are colours made by combining a secondary colour with a primary colour. There are six colours considered tertiary. In the RYB colour wheel, these tertiary colours are red-orange, yellow-orange, yellow-green, blue-green, blue-violet, and red-violet.



Here is the combination to create tertiary colours:

Magenta (Red-Purple) = Red + Purple Violet (Blue-Purple) = Blue + Purple

Vermillion (Red-Orange) = Red + Orange Amber (Yellow-Orange) = Yellow + Orange

Teal (Blue-Green) = Blue + Green Chartreuse (Yellow-Green) = Yellow + Green

Colour Terminologies - A Closer Look

Now that you know about the colour wheel, let's take it one step further with hue, saturation, brightness, value, tone, chroma, tint and shade. Describing colour is best done by these key terms. Let's cover what exactly these terms

mean! These are terms you might not encounter in daily life, but they're the key to understanding more nuanced colours—like all those little paint chips at the home improvement store.



Hue

Hue is the easiest one; it's basically just another word for colour. In the example below, you might describe the hue as coral pink or light red, depending on your interpretation.

Hue is one of the main properties of colour and is the property of light by which the colour of an object is classified as red, blue, green, or yellow in the colour spectrum.

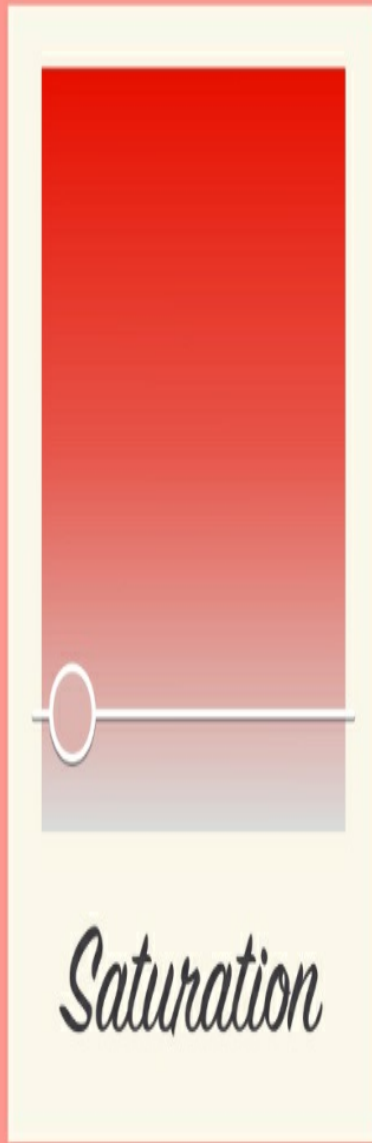
Green, orange, yellow, and blue — each of these is a hue, a colour or a shade. A rainbow shows the melting of one hue into another, from red to violet, and all the shades in between. The noun hue means both a colour and a shade of a colour. Green is a hue, and turquoise is a hue of both green and blue!



Hue

Saturation

Saturation refers to intensity—in other words, whether the colour appears subtler or more vibrant. Saturation is the intensity of a hue from a gray tone with no saturation, to pure, vivid colour with high saturation.



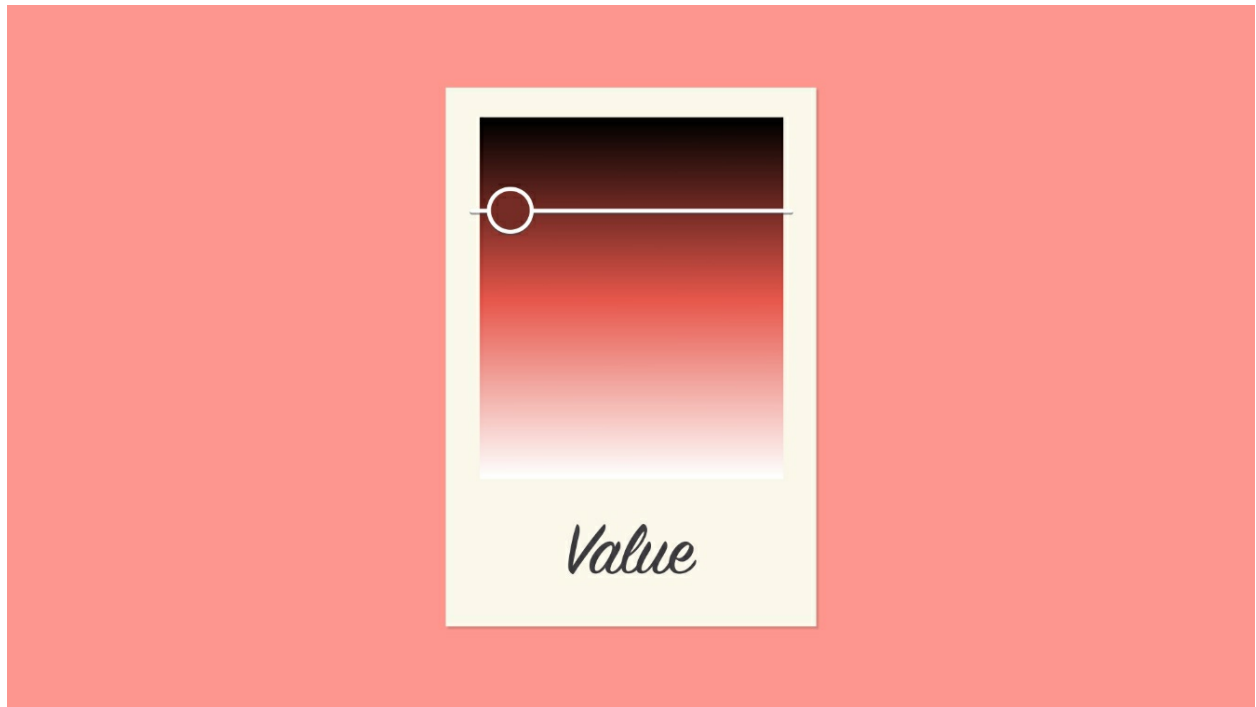
Saturation



Highly saturated colours are brighter, richer, more colourful or deep. De-saturated or low saturation colours have less pigment and will come off muted or pastel.

Value

Value has to do with how dark or light the colour is, ranging from black to white. As you can see below, this gives us many different shades, from a deep reddish brown to a light pastel pink.

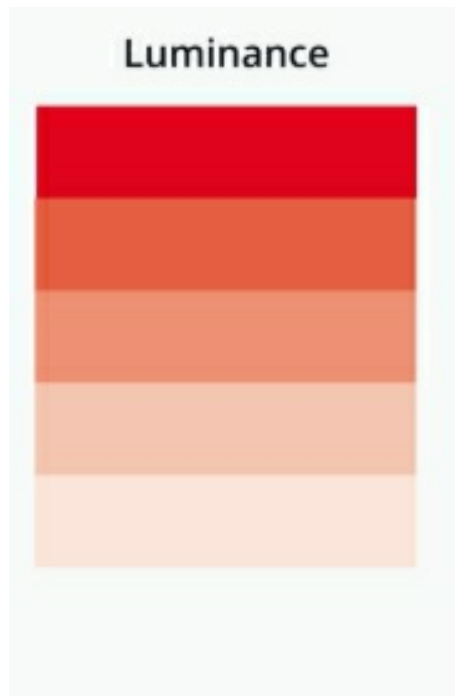


Value in the art will refer to the shadows and highlights and will give your work more dimension. It is especially important in black and white photos, design and illustration as it will separate objects from each other and their background.

Brightness

Brightness is simply both the hue of colour along with the value of the colour. It refers to its lightness and its ability to replicate light or reflection. This is also known as “luminance.”

Luminance is the amount of brightness or light in a colour.



Tone

Tone is a colour to which black and white (or grey) have been added. This darkens the original hue while making the colour appear more subtle and less intense.

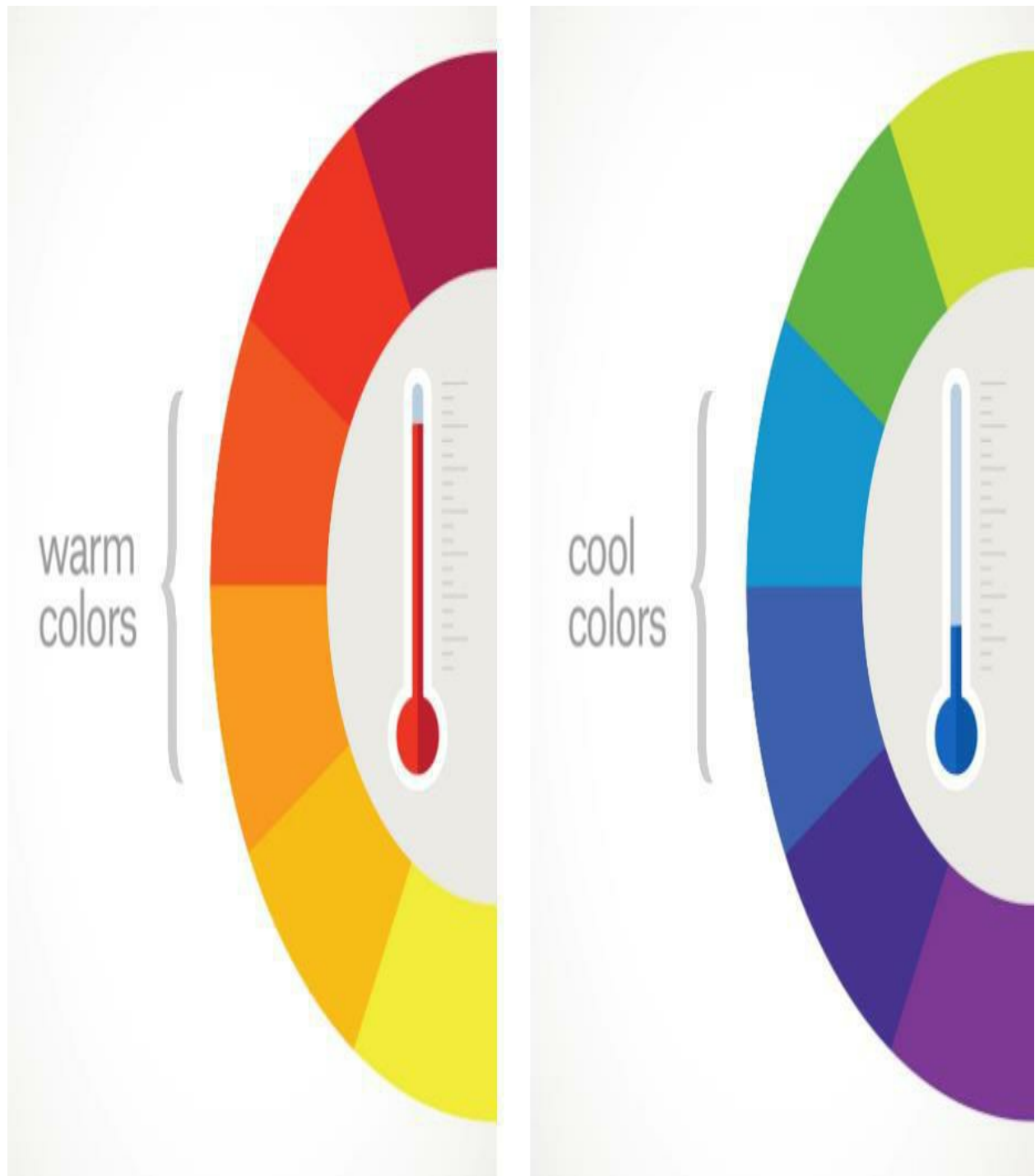


Warm and Cool Colours

The colour wheel can also be divided into warm and cool colours. The warmth or coolness of a colour is also known as its colour temperature. The colour combinations found on a colour wheel often have a balance of warm and cool colours. According to colour psychology, different colour temperatures evoke different feelings. For example, warm colours are said to bring to mind coziness and energy, while cool colours are associated with serenity and isolation.

Warm colours are the colours from red through to yellow. These colours are said to bring to mind warmth, like the sun.

Cool colours are the colours from blue to green and purple. These colours are said to bring to mind coolness, like water.



Tint

A tint is a hue to which white has been added. For example, red + white = pink.



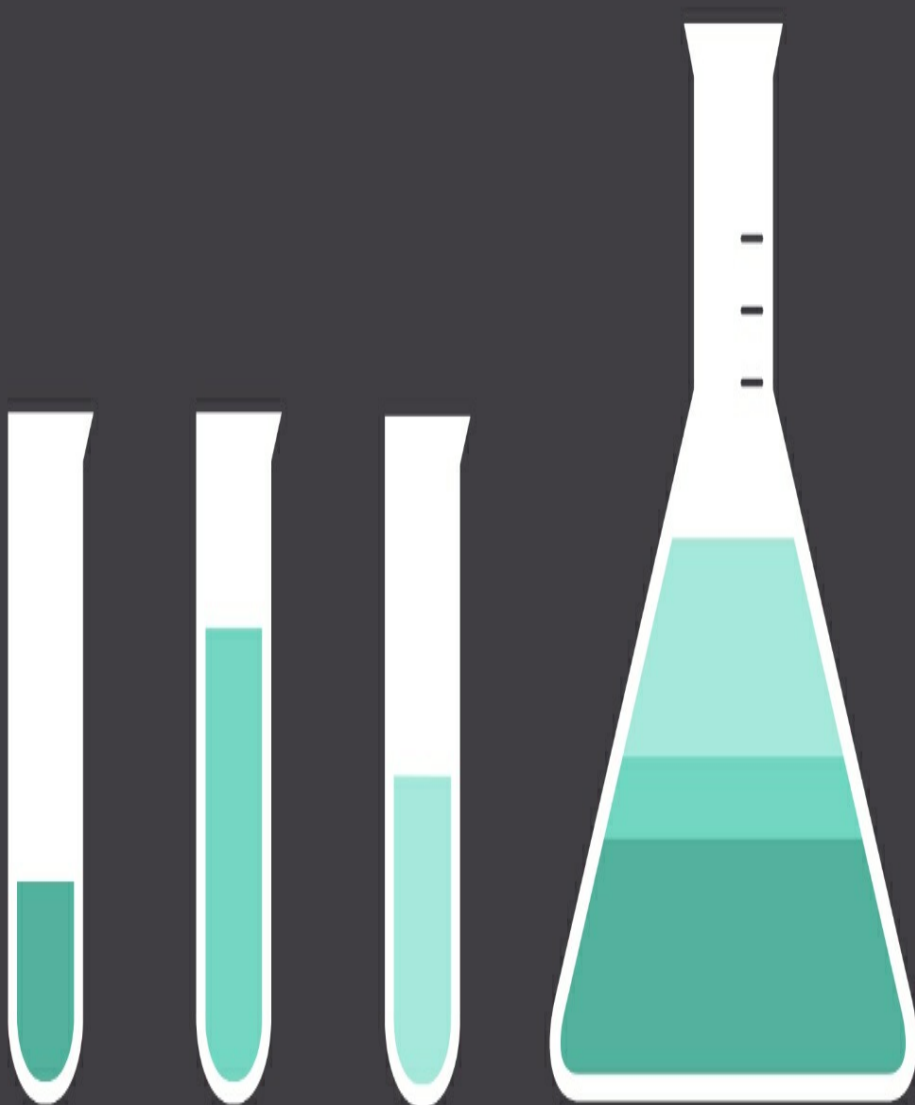
Shade

A shade is a hue to which black has been added. For example, red + black = burgundy.



Creating Colour Schemes

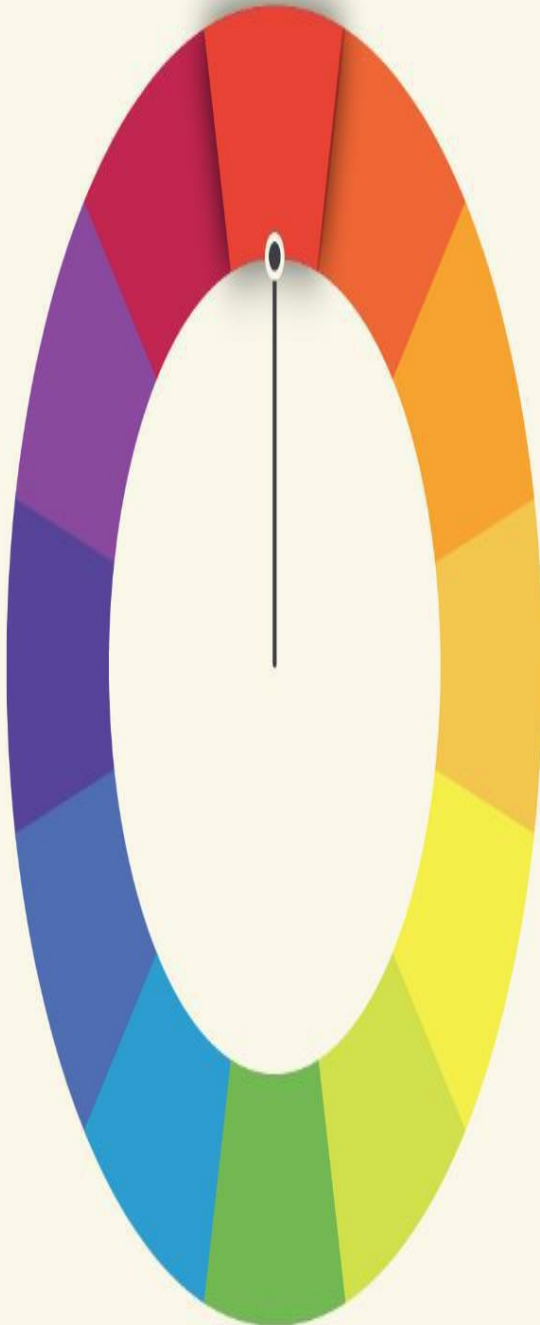
So how do we put this all together to create professional-looking colour schemes? There are actually tried-and-true formulas based on something called colour harmony that can help.



Colour harmony uses the colour wheel to illustrate time-tested colour combinations. We'll explore some of the most common types of harmony below.

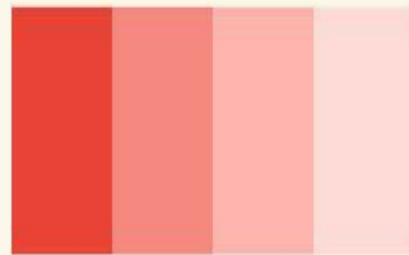
Monochromatic

The easiest formula for harmony is monochromatic because it only uses one colour or hue. To create a monochromatic colour scheme, pick a spot on the colour wheel, then use your knowledge of saturation and value to create variations.



Formula:

Monochromatic



The best thing about monochromatic colour schemes is that they're guaranteed to match. The colours suit each other perfectly because they're all from the same family.

Complementary

Complementary colours are opposite each other on the wheel; for instance, blue and orange or the classic red and green.

Complementary colours of graphic designs provide high contrast and high impact colour combination. When placed together or next to one another these colours will appear brighter and more vibrant.

To avoid complementary colour schemes that are too simplistic, add some variety by introducing lighter, darker, or de-saturated tones.

Analogous

An analogous colour scheme uses colours that are next to each other on the wheel, like reds and oranges or blues and greens.



Formula:

Analogous



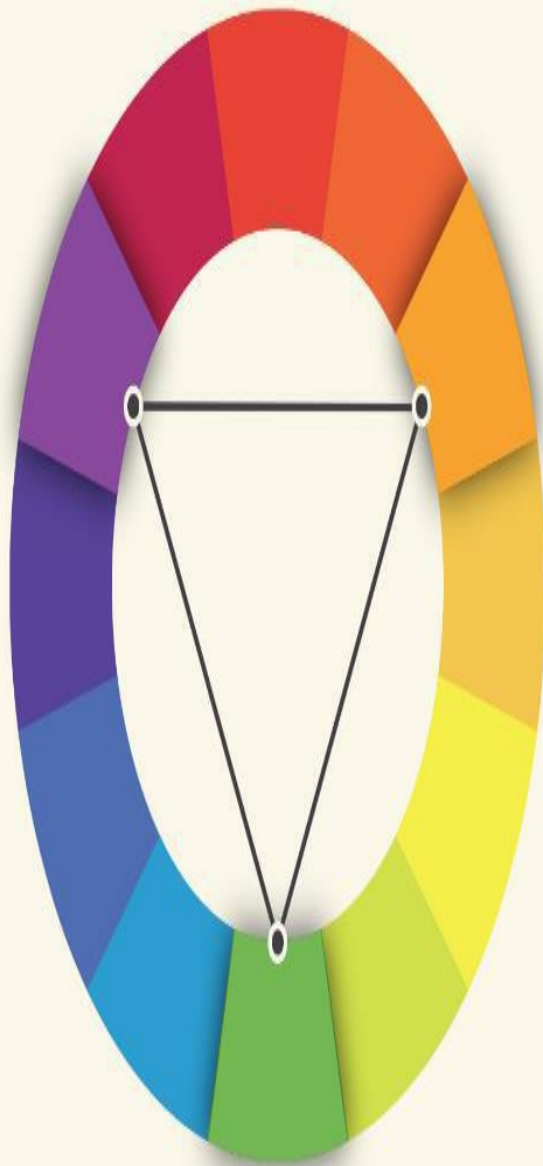
Analogous colours are among the easiest to find on the colour wheel. Pick any colour at any point on the wheel. Now, look at any three colours directly to the left or right of the chosen colour. Together, those four are a group of analogous colours. Mixing colours that are adjacent to each other creates a colourful yet harmonious look. When using an analogous colour scheme it's best to choose one main colour, using the other three as accent colours. This will help keep designs from becoming too chaotic or busy.

Split-Complementary

A split-complementary colour scheme uses the colours on either side of the complement. It involves the use of three colours. Start with one colour, find its complement and then use the two colours on either side of it. This gives you the same level of contrast as a complementary colour scheme but more colours to work with (and potentially more interesting results).

Triadic

A triadic colour scheme uses three colours that are evenly spaced, forming a perfect triangle on the wheel.



Formula:

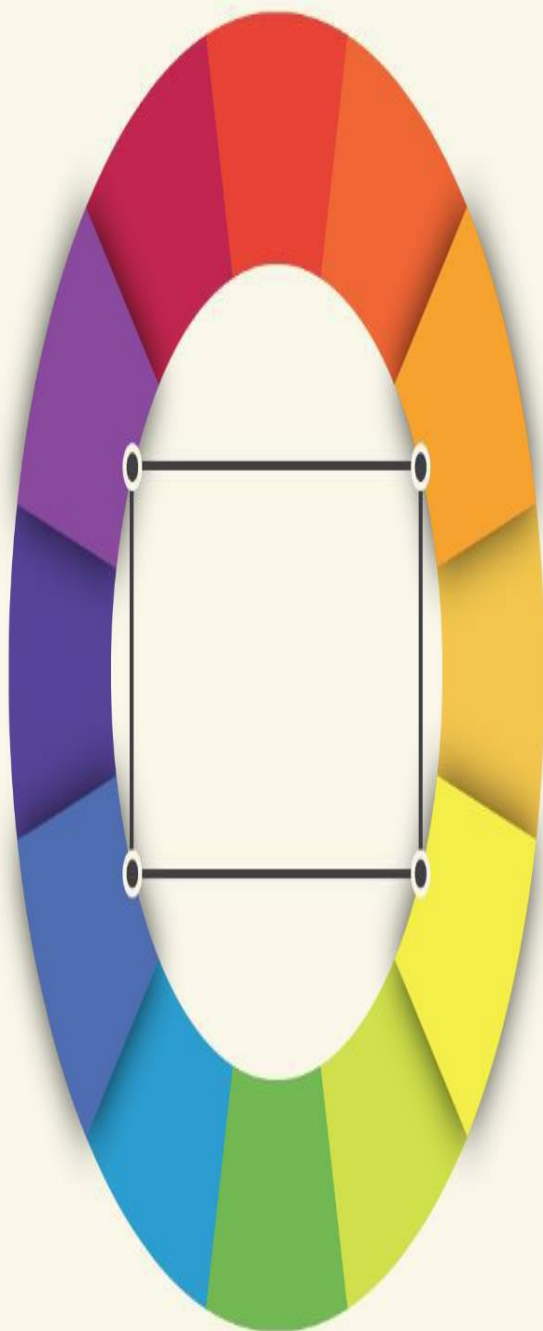
Triadic



These combinations tend to be pretty striking—especially when they include primary or secondary colours—so be mindful when using them in your work.

Tetradic

Tetradic colour schemes form a rectangle on the wheel, using not one but two complementary colour pairs. This formula works best if you let one colour dominate while the others serve as an accent.



Formula:

Tetradic



Avoiding common mistakes

There are a few classic dos and don'ts when it comes to colour. For instance, have you ever seen colours that seem to vibrate when they're placed next to each other?



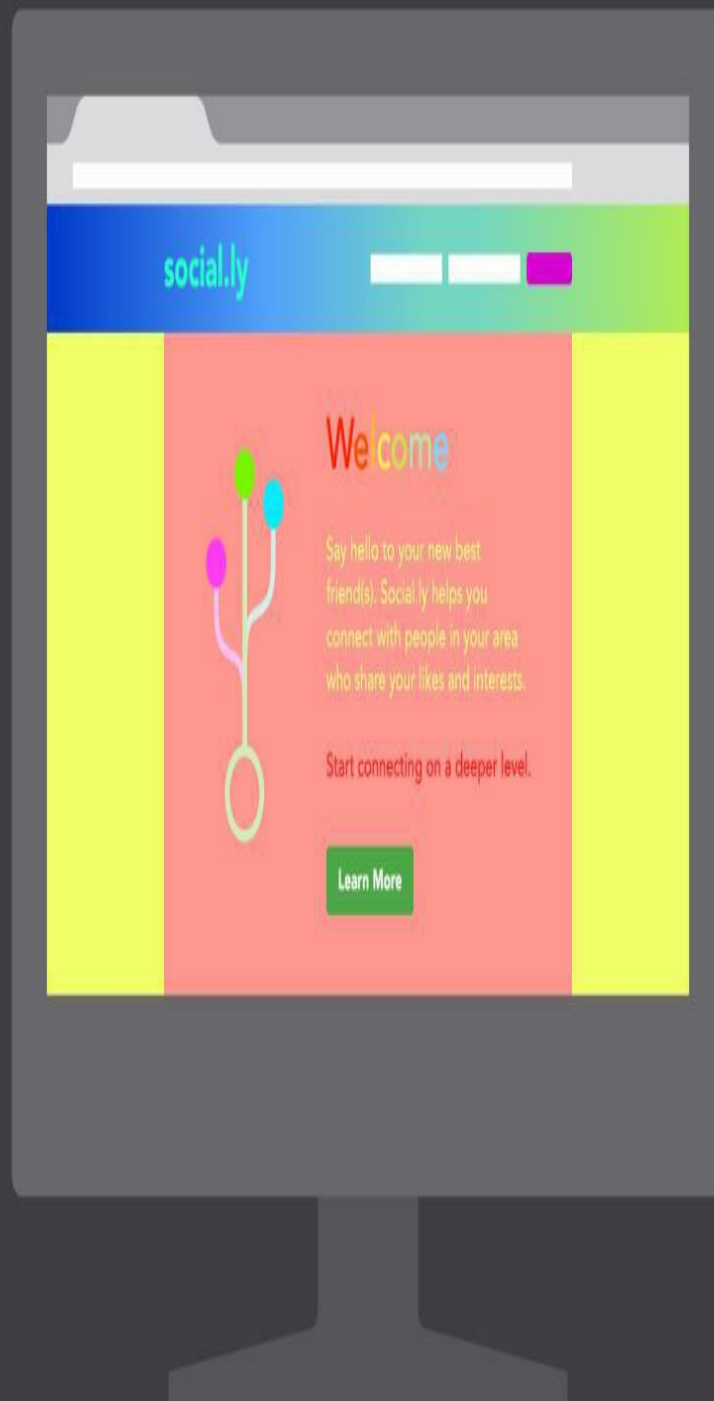
The solution is to tone it down —literally—and there's a simple way to do it. Start with one colour, and try adjusting its lightness, darkness, or saturation. Sometimes a little contrast is all your colour palette needs.



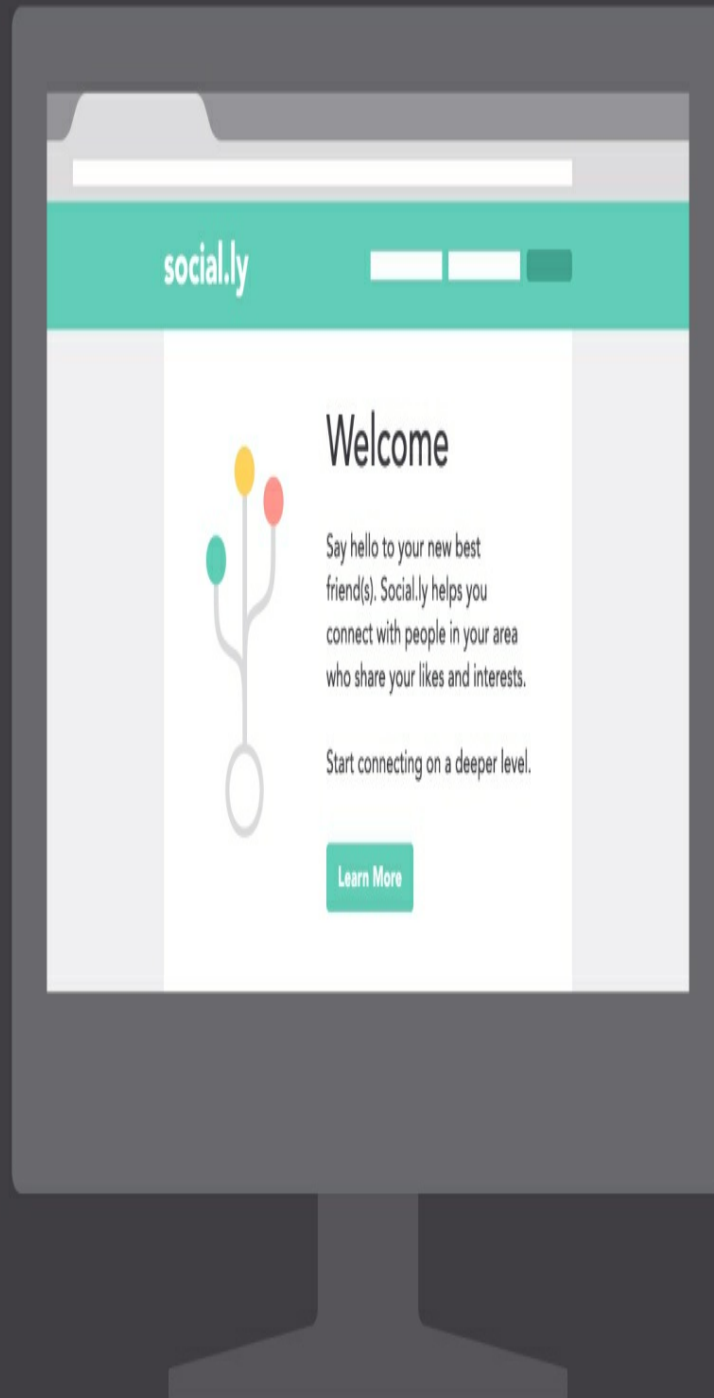
Ahh... that's
much better.

Readability is an important factor in any design. Your colours should be legible and easy on the eyes, especially when working with text.

Sometimes that means NOT using colour—at least not in every little detail.



Neutral colours like black, white, and gray can help you balance your design, so when you do use colour, it really stands out.



Choosing the right colours

Every colour sends a message. It's important to consider the tone of your project, and choose a colour palette that fits.

For example, bright colours tend to have a fun or modern vibe.



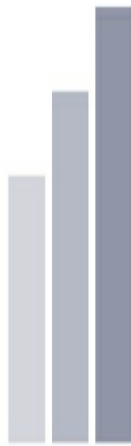
Snip/Cut

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SNIPCUT.COM

Desaturated colours often appear more serious or businesslike.



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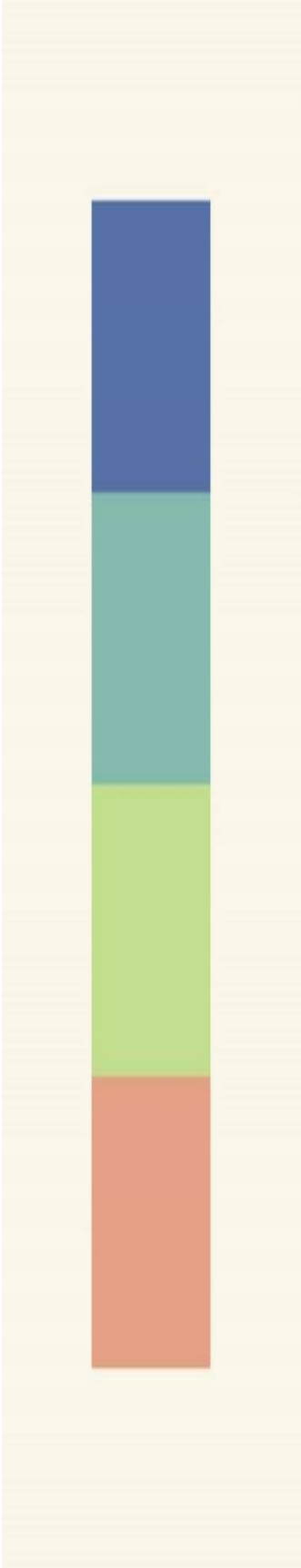
nyazdani@sanfordfinancial.com

www.sanfordfinancial.com

Sometimes it just depends on the context. With practice and creativity, there's no limit to what you can do.

Finding Inspiration

You can find ideas for colour schemes in all kinds of interesting places, from advertising and branding to famous works of art.



Using Web Resources

You can use a web resource to browse colour palettes or generate your own. Experienced designers often take inspiration from the world around them. There's nothing wrong with finding something you like and making it your own.

Pet First

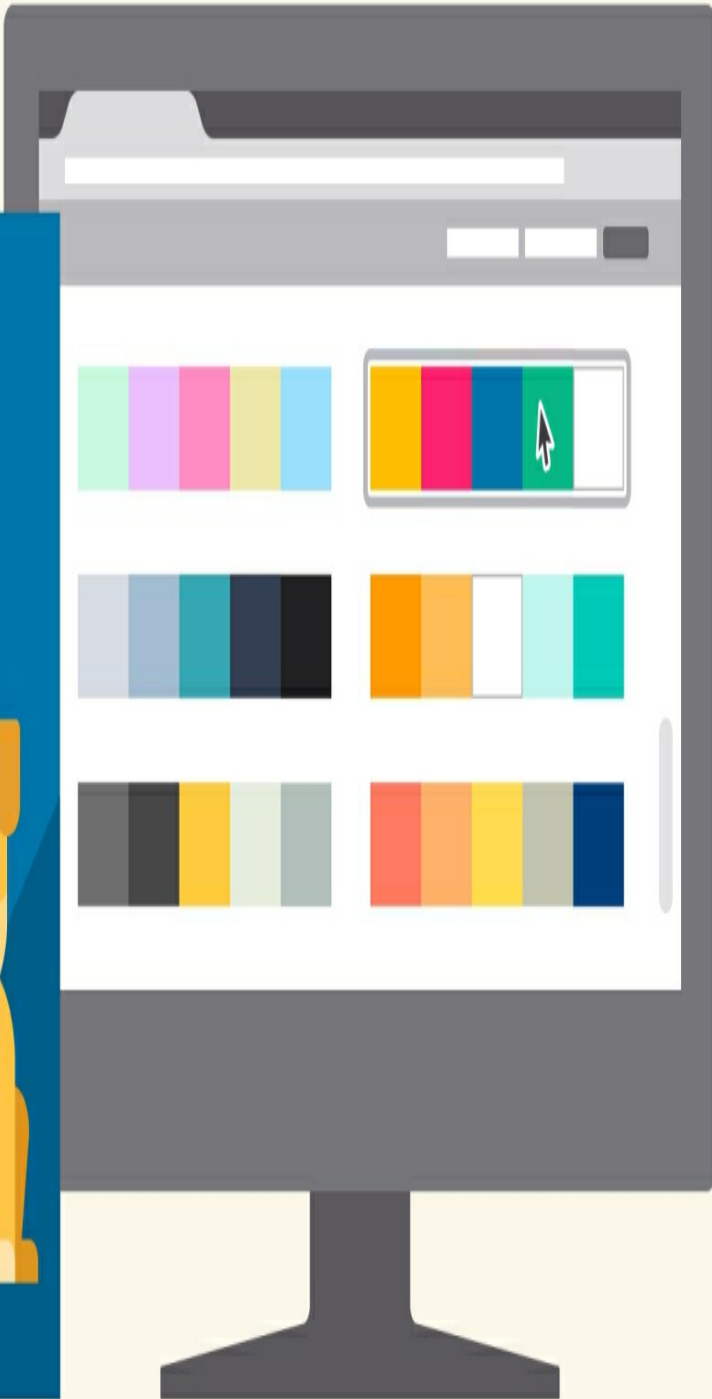
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Now Open!



Putting it all together

Everywhere you look, there's colour, colour, and more colour. It can be intimidating to use it in your work, but it doesn't have to be. Just keep experimenting, and remember what you've learned about colour theory. Soon, choosing great-looking colours will feel like second nature.

Online Resources for Colours

If you cannot seem to pick out colours suitable for your design on your own, you can seek help using online sources to create a nice design. Here are a few and they include:

1. **Coolors** (<https://www.coolors.com>)
2. **Colour Hunt** (<https://colourhunt.co/>)
3. **COLOURLovers** (<https://www.colourlovers.com>)
4. **Paletton** (<https://paletton.com>)
5. **Google Colours** (<https://brandpalettes.com/google-colours>)
6. **Adobe Colours CC**
7. **Canva** (<https://www.canva.com/colours/colour-wheel>)

Conclusion

Don't be afraid to play with the palette and create your own unique interpretation. That's what colour harmony is all about; the formulas are merely starting points to help guide and inspire you.

The Colour Mixing Model

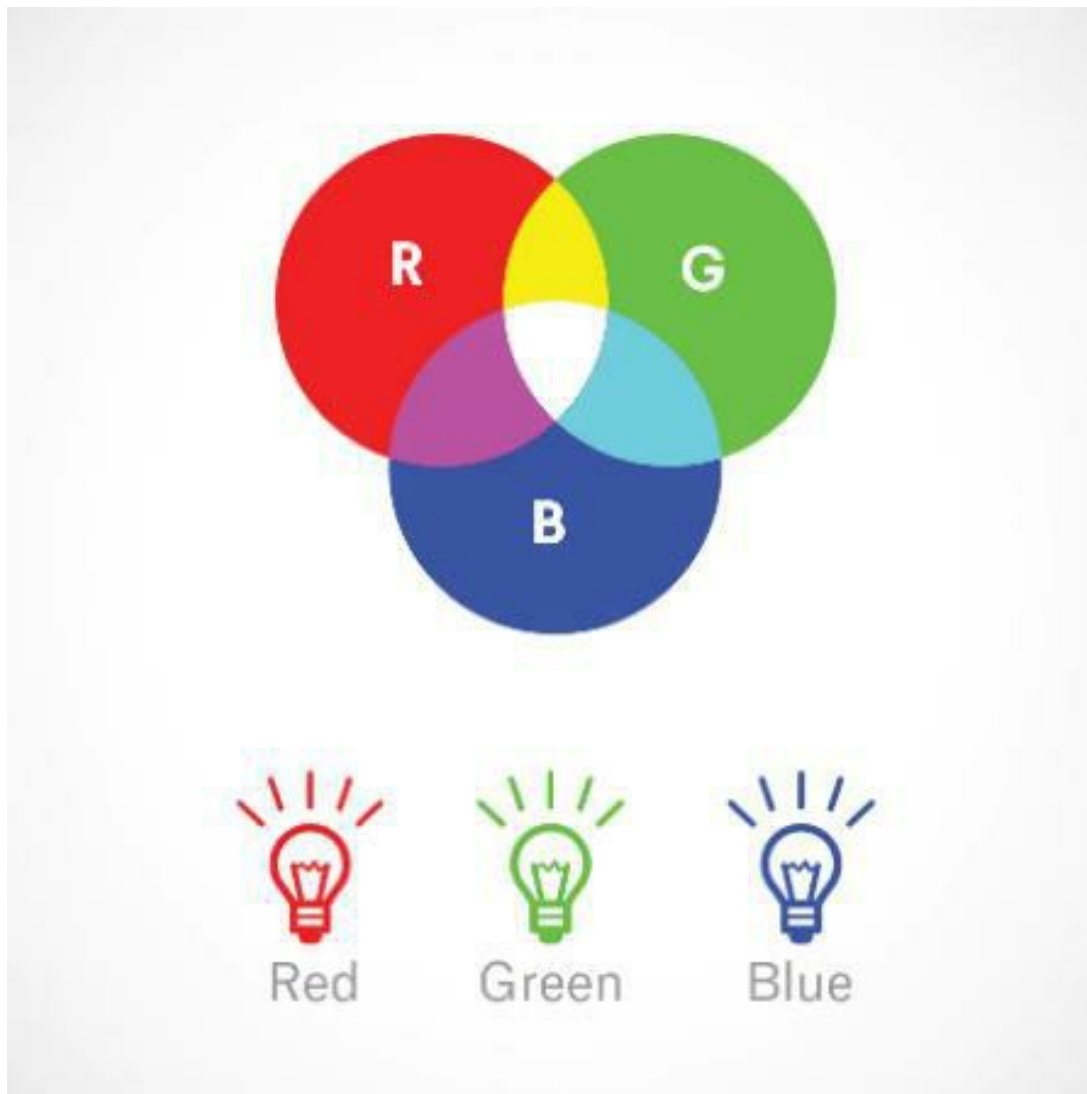
Humans see colours in light waves. The colour mixing model refers to the models that exist in graphic design? Two colour models exist in today's world: The additive model (RGB) and the subtractive model (CMYK).

RGB: The Additive Colour Mixing Model

RGB stands for Red, Green and, Blue. RGB is known as the additive colour mixing model. Mixing light—or the additive colour mixing model—allows you to create colours by mixing red, green and blue light sources of various intensities. The more light you add, the brighter the colour mix becomes. If you mix all three colours of light, you get pure, white light.

Electronic displays: TVs, screens and projectors use red, green and blue (RGB) as their primary colours, and then mix them together to create other colours.

The RGB scale is 0 to 255. In RGB, black is $R=0$, $B=0$ and $G=0$, and white is $R=255$, $B=255$, and $G=255$.



Let's say you have a very distinct brand with a bright yellow logo. If you post the logo on Facebook, Twitter or your website and don't use the correct colour process, your logo will appear muddy instead of that bright yellow. That's why, when working with files for any screen, use RGB, not CMYK.

CMYK: The Subtractive Colour Mixing Model

Any colour you see on a physical surface (paper, signage, packaging, etc.) uses the subtractive colour mixing model. Most people are more familiar with this colourmodel because it's what we learned in kindergarten when mixing finger paints. In this case, "subtractive" simply refers to the fact that you subtract the light from the paper by adding more colours.

Often you are printing on white papers. Adding colours block the white paper from coming through. The CMYK scale ranges from 0 to 100. When C=100, M=100, Y=100 and K=100 you get black colour. The opposite is white, which is C=0, M=0, Y=0 and K=0.



Why

should you care?

Printing is very expensive especially when you are printing a full colour project. Therefore, it is important that colours are in the right model to avoid waste of money.

Since printing uses the subtractive colour mixing method, getting accurate colour reproduction can only be achieved by using CMYK. Using RGB will not only result in inaccurate colour.

GRAPHIC DESIGN SOFTWARE

Graphic Design Software

Presently, there are a variety of design software available for use. Some are free while others are not. Adobe products such as Photoshop, Illustrator and

InDesign are mainstays in the graphic design world. However, you will need to purchase these programs and pay a monthly subscription fee to be able to use its full features. If you are just beginning and don't want to commit to the high price tag Adobe products often carry, similar free open-source software such as GIMP can help you begin to master the basics.

Graphic designers are expected to be proficient in software programs for image-making, typography and layout. Nearly all of the popular and "industry standard" software programs used by graphic designers since the early 1990s are products of Adobe Systems Incorporated. Adobe Photoshop (a raster-based program for photo editing) and Adobe Illustrator (a vector-based program for drawing) are often used in the final stage. Also, some designers use CorelDraw. CorelDraw is a vector graphics editor software developed and marketed by Corel Corporation. You will need to purchase the software to be able to use it.

Raster images may be edited in Adobe Photoshop, logos and illustrations in Adobe Illustrator and CorelDraw, and the final product assembled in one of the major page layout programs, such as Adobe InDesign, Serif PagePlus and QuarkXpress.

Open source software used to edit the vector graphics is Inkscape. Primary file format used in Inkscape is Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG). You can import or export the file in any other vector format. Designers often use pre-designed raster images and vector graphics in their work from online design databases. Powerful open-source programs (which are free) are also used by both professionals and casual users for graphic design, these include Inkscape (for vector graphics), GIMP (for photo-editing and image manipulation), Krita (for painting), and Scribus (for page layout).

CONCLUSION

So far, I believe that you have learned a great deal from this book. We have looked at major concepts around the design niche. From colours to typography, we have really covered a lot.

However, it is noteworthy that most elements used in our design process are not entirely original. That is, they are not created by us, especially images, vectors and fonts.

Copyright is an important part of the design industry. As much as there are freely licensed resources, there are also resources that are premium which requires permission (purchase) before you can be allowed to use them. But due to the lack of strict regulations in the industry, most designers don't give it much thought.

As an emerging designer, it is important to acknowledge the work of other either by paying them or sending regards to them, depending on where you get such resources. Infringement or theft of intellectual property is a serious which needs to be taking seriously.

To this end, it is important that you check out whether the resources you are using for your design is freely licensed (open-source) or paid for.

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